

EF1

MODULE 01

BUSINESS ENGLISH ESSENTIALS FOR TEAMS



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Lesson 01

Introduction and Networking



Warm-up



Quick Discussion:

1. Have you ever attended networking events?
2. How important is networking in your job?
3. In what other situations do you need to network with people?



Role-Play

Scenario 1: Anna met Tom at a regional business conference networking event.

Anna: Good morning. ***I don't think we've met yet.*** My name's Anna Lee. I'm a marketing manager at Bright Ideas Ltd.

Tom: Nice to meet you, Anna. I'm Tom Nguyen, I work in product development at GreenTech.

Anna: Great to meet you, Tom. ***Is this your first time at this conference?***

Tom: Yes, it is. I'm here to learn more about new trends in sustainable technology. How about you? ***What brings you here today?***

Anna: Oh, I've attended for the past three years. I'm here to meet industry contacts and see the latest marketing ideas for eco-friendly products.

Tom: ***That sounds interesting.*** What kind of projects are you working on at the moment?

Anna: Well, we're launching a new social media campaign for a renewable energy product.

Tom: Really? ***That sounds great. How is it going so far?***

Anna: It's going well. Our customers seem to engage with the eco-friendly message.

Tom: ***That's great to hear. I'd be happy to exchange contact details.*** Do you have a business card?

Anna: Of course! Here you go. ***Feel free to reach out anytime.***

Tom: Thank you, I will. Nice talking with you, Anna.

Anna: Likewise, Tom. Enjoy the rest of the conference.

Role-Play Analysis

1. Where does the conversation take place?
2. What is Anna's job position and company?
3. Why is each person attending the conference?
4. What do they exchange at the end of the conversation?



Key Phrases

FUNCTION	EXAMPLE PHRASES
Express interest/reaction	"That sounds interesting!" "Oh really?" "Wow, impressive."
Encourage more detail	"Tell me more about that." "How did you get involved in that?"
Relate to their experience	"That must be challenging." "I can imagine that's exciting."
Positive feedback	"That's great to hear." "I'd love to hear more."
Continue conversation	"What's your role in that project?" "How is it going so far?"



Intonation

Falling intonation (↘) – used in statements and Wh- questions

- Let me introduce myself. ↘
- I work in software development. ↘
- It was nice to meet you. ↘

Rising intonation (↗) – used in yes/no questions

- Are you working in the office today? ↗
- Are you attending the networking session later? ↗



Intonation Practice

Directions: Take turns saying these sentences with correct intonation

1. Please introduce yourself.
2. Will you be in the meeting later?
3. I work as a software developer at ABC tech.
4. Have you been to this tech conference before?
5. It's a pleasure to meet you.
6. Would you like to exchange contact details?
7. We specialize in cloud computing solutions.
8. Where did you work before joining this company?
9. Can I introduce you to my colleague?
10. Is this your first time working on AI projects?



Practice

Showing Interest: Practice using phrases to show interest.

Instructions:

1. Write five sentences about your current or past work.

Example: *I usually oversee the tasks of my members.*

2. Work with a partner and take turns sharing your sentences.
3. Each time your partner shares something, respond by using an expression of interest.
4. Switch roles until both partners finish their turn.



Challenge

NETWORKING INTRODUCTION

Instructions:

1. Work with a partner.
2. Imagine you are at a professional networking event.
3. Take turns introducing yourself to your partner.
 - **Introduce yourself**
 - **Say what you do**
 - **Name your company/department**
 - **Say why you're at the event**
4. After both of you have finished introducing yourselves, prepare to introduce your partner to the class confidently.

Example:

"This is Anna. She works as a project coordinator at _____. She's currently interested in _____"



Key Vocabulary

Word/Phrase	Use	Example
What brings you here today?	Networking opener	<i>What brings you here today?</i> <i>Are you attending the AI workshop?</i>
Where do you work?	Asking about someone's workplace	<i>Where do you work?</i> – <i>I work at Tech Solutions</i>
I work in [industry/role]	Stating professional background	<i>I work in</i> cybersecurity as a network engineer.
Let me introduce myself.	Formal way to introduce yourself	<i>Let me introduce myself.</i> My name is _____, and I work in _____.
Would you like to exchange contact details?	Offering to stay in touch	<i>I'd love to connect.</i> <i>Would you like to exchange contact details?</i>
It's great to connect.	Used in networking situations	<i>It's great to connect.</i> Let's keep in touch!
Networking	Building and maintaining professional relationships to exchange information, gain opportunities, and grow in a career or industry	<i>Attending tech conferences and joining online forums are great ways for IT professionals to enhance their network and stay updated on industry trends.</i>
Make an impression...	Create a strong first impression	<i>A confident introduction helps you make a great first impression.</i>



Summary

- ✓ **Use formal greetings** (“Nice to meet you.”)
- ✓ **Introduce yourself professionally** (“Let me introduce myself. I work in [role] at [company].”)
- ✓ **Engage in small talk** (“What brings you here today?”)
- ✓ **Exchange contact details professionally** (“Would you like to connect on LinkedIn?”)

Lesson 02

Networking Practice



Warm-up



Quick Discussion:

1. In your country, how do you start a professional conversation?
2. What would be unusual or even rude if foreigners did it the wrong way?



Role-Play

Scenario 1: Low Context

Context: *Networking at a tech conference in San Francisco.*

Liam: Hi, I'm Liam. I work as a project manager at a mobile app startup. What do you do?

Olivia: Hi Liam, I'm Olivia. I'm a UX researcher at a design agency.

Liam: Cool! What projects are you working on?

Olivia: Mostly user testing for e-commerce apps. Last month, we redesigned a checkout process that increased conversions by 15%.

Liam: That's great! Do you work with international teams often?

Olivia: Yes, daily. We use Slack and video calls to stay aligned.

Liam: Makes sense. Remote collaboration is tricky but fun.

Scenario 2: High Context

Context: *Networking lunch at a business seminar in Seoul.*

Min Ji: Hello, I'm Min Ji from Seoul. I work in marketing at a local company. It's nice to meet you.

Hiroko: Hello Min Ji, I'm Hiroko, a brand manager at a Tokyo firm. Pleased to meet you.

Min Ji: Nice to meet you. I've heard your company runs interesting campaigns. What kinds do you usually do?

Hiroko: Mostly digital campaigns for lifestyle brands. Last month, we launched an influencer campaign for a skincare product.

Min Ji: Ah, I see. In Korea, we often coordinate internally before launching. Do you also focus on internal alignment?

Hiroko: Yes, absolutely. Coordination between marketing, design, and sales is essential.

Min Ji: That's very thoughtful. Perhaps we can share insights about the Asian market sometime.

Role-Play Analysis:

1. In which conversation do the speakers share detailed facts and results quickly?
2. In which conversation do the speakers spend more time on polite greetings and formalities before giving details?
3. How do Liam and Olivia show interest in each other's work compared to Min Ji and Hiroko?
4. Which conversation feels more direct, and which feels more indirect? Why do you think so?
5. How might these different styles affect how people follow up after meeting?

Key Concepts

Low-Context Cultures

- Communication is direct and explicit.
- Information is clearly stated; little is left to interpretation.
- Focus is on task, efficiency, and clarity.
- Relationships are less crucial for conveying meaning.

Example:

Two professionals meet at a conference. They shake hands firmly, look each other in the eyes, and say: "Good day, I am Müller. Nice to meet you."

High-Context Cultures

- Communication is indirect and implicit.
- Meaning relies on context, relationships, and shared knowledge.
- Focus is on harmony, respect, and social cues.
- Relationships and trust are often more important than words alone.

Example:

An employee meets his new co-worker. He bowed slightly while saying, "Nice to meet you. I am Tanaka." The other returned a slightly deeper bow before introducing himself.



Practice

Safe vs Taboo Networking Topics

Instructions:

1. The class will be divided into two groups.
2. Each group writes down 3–5 topics that fit their category.
 - **Group 1:** Safe networking topics.
 - **Group 2:** Taboo networking topics.
3. Discuss why these certain topics are considered safe/taboo and compare it with your own culture.



Challenge

NETWORKING IN AN INTERNATIONAL SETTING

Instructions:

1. You will be assigned a cultural profile.
2. Consider how this profile communicates: greeting style, conversation style, and safe vs taboo topics.
3. Introduce yourself clearly and use culturally appropriate online greetings
4. Practice the full networking flow while following your assigned cultural profile in the class.

Suggested flow of conversation:

- **Introduce Yourself** – Share your name, role, and brief background.
- **Exchange Greetings** – Smile, nod, or wave according to your profile.
- **Ask About Personal Details** – Work experience, professional interests... Avoid taboo topics.

- **Agree to Keep in Contact** – Share email, LinkedIn, or virtual contact info politely.
- **End the Conversation** – Thank your partner and close politely.

Profile A – High-Context Communicator

- Prioritizes relationships, harmony, and politeness.
- Uses indirect or subtle language to convey meaning.
- Observes social cues carefully and avoids taboo topics.
- Focuses on building trust before sharing detailed information.

Profile B – Low-Context Communicator

- Prioritizes clarity, efficiency, and directness.
- Uses explicit language and gets straight to the point.
- Comfortable discussing information and achievements.
- Focuses on exchanging information quickly, less emphasis on relationship-building.

Discussion

1. Do you prefer people to be direct about their ideas or more indirect? Why?
2. Why is listening an important skill in cross-cultural networking?
3. What's one thing you would change about your usual networking style when meeting people from a different culture?

Lesson 03

Organization Basics



Warm-up

Discussion:

- What departments does your company have?
- Who do you report to in your company? What is their role?
- Do you think a clear company structure is important? Why or why not?



Role-Play

Scenario: *Company Structure Introduction*

Role-Play Dialogue

John: Welcome to Global Solutions, James! Let me give you a quick overview of our company structure. ***Our company is structured into multiple departments.*** You'll be joining the Software Development ***Department.*** ***This team is responsible for*** developing and optimizing our backend systems.

James: Got it. Who will I be reporting to?

John: Your ***direct report*** is Sarah Nguyen, the Team Lead for Backend Development.

James: And who does she report to?

John: Sarah ***reports to*** Daniel Lee, the Engineering Manager. He's your ***line manager.***

James: I see. How does communication flow within the company?

John: We follow a clear ***company hierarchy*** with a ***chain of command.*** If you have any technical issues, you discuss them with Sarah first.

James: Thanks for explaining.

Role-Play Analysis

Answer the following questions:

1. Which department will James be joining?
2. Who is James's direct report?
3. What is Sarah Nguyen's position in the company?
4. Who is James's line manager?
5. Who should James contact first if he has a technical issue?



Vocabulary: Describing a Company's Structure

When introducing a company's structure, you can use these phrases:

- To explain the general organization of a company:
 - ***Our company is structured into multiple departments.***
- To describe who your direct manager is:
 - ***I report to [position].***
- To explain a team's role in the company:
 - ***This team is responsible for [task].***

Example: ***Our company is structured into multiple departments. I work in the Software Development Department, and I report to the Team Lead. This team is responsible for backend development and system optimization.***



Practice

1. Match:

Match the terms with their definitions:

- | | |
|------------------------------------|--|
| 1. Department | a. A manager directly responsible for employees' work. |
| 2. Company hierarchy | b. An employee who reports to a specific manager. |
| 3. Direct report | c. The official line of authority in an organization. |
| 4. Chain of command | d. The ranking of positions within an organization. |
| 5. Organizational structure | e. A division of a company responsible for a specific function. |
| 6. Line manager | f. The framework that defines how tasks are divided and coordinated. |

2. Role-play: Describing a company's structure

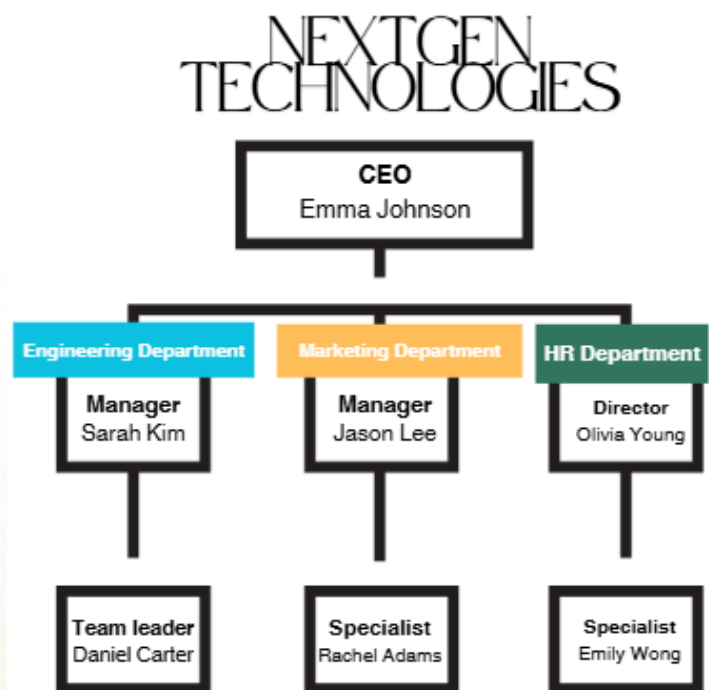
You are an HR employee at NextGen Technologies. Your manager has asked you to explain the company's organizational structure to a new employee based on the company's **organizational chart**.

Useful key phrases:

- *Our company is structured into multiple departments.*
- *I report to the [position].*
- *This team is responsible for [task].*

Example:

Your **direct report** is Daniel Carter, the Team Leader for Engineering Development.





Production

Business Debate: Experience or Leadership?

Work in pairs or small groups and discuss your opinions about the following statement:

A manager should be the most experienced person on the team.

STEPS:

1. Decide on your role:

Team	Team A: Proposition Team	Team B: Opposition Team
Tasks	Agrees with the statement	Disagrees with the statement

2. Prepare your arguments:

Prepare 01-02 clear arguments to support your position. You may consider factors such as:

- Leadership and decision-making
- Years of experience vs management skills
- Team respect and authority

3. Conduct the debate:

Each team takes turns and conducts the debate in the following format:

1. **Opening arguments:** introducing the team's position
2. **Supporting arguments:** giving examples and supporting details
3. **Counter-arguments:** responding to the other team's arguments
4. **Closing statement:** providing summarizations and conclusions

4. Useful phrases:

- **Stating your opinion:** *"I believe that...", "In my opinion..."*
- **Giving reasons:** *"One strong reason is...", "For example, ..."*
- **Stating counter-arguments:** *"I see your point, but I think..."*
- **Summarizing or Concluding:** *"To sum up"*



Key Vocabulary

Word/Phrase	Definitions	Example
Department	A division of a company responsible for a specific function.	<i>I work in the Marketing Department, which is responsible for managing campaigns and brand awareness.</i>
Company hierarchy	The ranking of positions within an organization.	<i>In our company hierarchy, the CEO is at the top, followed by department heads and then team managers.</i>
Direct report	An employee who reports to a specific manager.	<i>As a team leader, I have three direct reports who handle content creation and social media strategy.</i>
Chain of command	The official line of authority in an organization.	<i>If there's an issue with a project, we follow the chain of command and report it to our line manager first before escalating it</i>
Organizational structure	The framework that defines how tasks are divided and coordinated.	<i>Our organizational structure is divided into different teams, including sales, engineering, and customer support.</i>
Line manager	A manager directly responsible for employees' work.	<i>My line manager is Jason Lee, the Marketing Manager, who oversees my daily tasks and approves my projects.</i>

Lesson 04

Describing Your Organization



Role-Play

Mike: Hi Meg, do you have a minute? I'm still trying to get my head around the **company structure** here.

Meg: Sure, Mike. It can be a bit complex at first. What's confusing you?

Mike: I know we're a **subsidiary** of a larger international group, but how does that affect our daily work?

Meg: We have a lot of independence, but big decisions—like budgets—go to the **corporate level**.

Mike: Got it. And the different **divisions**? I'm in Marketing, but not sure how we connect with Sales.

Meg: Each division has a department head, and they coordinate regularly. Our **reporting structure** is clear—your Team Leader reports to the Head of Marketing, and so on.

Mike: That helps. And what's the **company culture** like?

Meg: It's pretty good. We try to foster a collaborative environment. People are encouraged to share ideas, and there are regular team-building events.

Mike: That's great to hear. I was a little worried about the size of the company, but it seems well-structured. Thanks, Meg. That clears things up.

Meg: Anytime, Mike!

Role-play Analysis:

1. Who does Mike's 'Team Leader' report to, according to Meg?
2. What part of the company makes big financial decisions, the 'subsidiary' or the 'corporate' group?
3. How does Meg describe the 'company culture' and teamwork?
4. What are the two 'divisions' mentioned by Meg, and how do they work together?
5. Who is in charge of each 'division' according to Meg?



Key Phrases: How to confirm information

Confirming information is an important communication skill in professional settings. It helps you check that you have understood something correctly and avoid misunderstandings.

Confirming	Examples
1. Tag questions – “right?”	• He has a meeting this morning, right? • We’ve already sent the proposal, right?
2. Tag questions – auxiliary verb	• He went to the trade fair in San Francisco, didn’t he? • I’m going to get an email with the details, aren’t I? • He hasn’t finished the presentation, has he?
3. Negative questions	• Doesn’t she work in International Sales? • Isn’t he responsible for the project? • Didn’t we meet at the conference last year?

Grammar: Tag Question

1. Definition:

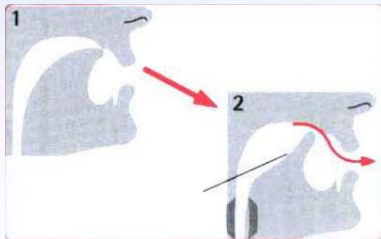
- A short question added to the end of a statement to turn it into a question.
- Used to confirm information or seek agreement.

2. Rules:

Rules	Examples
1. Positive Statement, Negative Tag	You are coming, aren't you?
2. Negative Statement, Positive Tag	He hasn't finished the presentation, has he?
3. Auxiliary verb / Modal verb	• You can stay for the call, can't you? • We should send the invoice today, shouldn't we? • They will confirm the booking, won't they?
4. Special cases:	
I am	I'm going to get an email with the details, aren't I?
Must: Obligation or Necessity (Present or Future) → use modal	You must finish your work, mustn't you?
Must: Assumption or Deduction → use verb	• She must be tired, isn't she? • He must have left, hasn't he?
Indefinite pronoun (people) → Pronoun in the tag = They	• Someone called, didn't they? • Nobody was here, were they?
Indefinite pronoun (thing) → Pronoun in the tag = It	Everything is still alright, isn't it?
This/That → Pronoun in the tag = It	This is your book, isn't it?
These/Those → Pronoun in the tag = They	These are your shoes, aren't they?
"I think", "I believe", "I suppose" → The tag question is formed based on the main clause	I think she is coming, isn't she?



Pronunciation



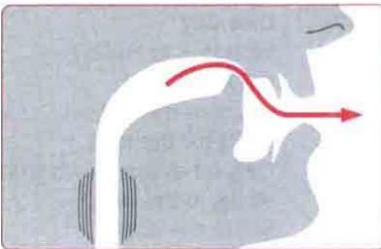
/dʒ/

j: job - /dʒɒb/

g: general - /'dʒenrəl/

ge: age - /eɪdʒ/

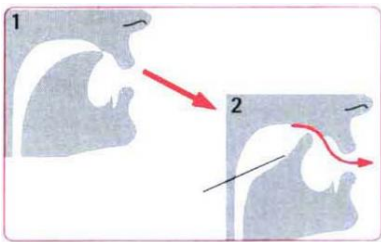
dge: fridge - /frɪdʒ/



/ʒ/

si: Asia - /'eɪʒə/

s: usually - /'ju:ʒuəli/



/tʃ/

ch: choose - /tʃu:z/

t: future - /'fju:tʃə(r)/, question - /'kwestʃən/

tch: catch - /kætʃ/



Practice

1. Fill in the blanks with the correct words or phrases from the lesson.

1. The ____ of our IT department is responsible for overseeing all software development projects.
2. Our company operates as ____ of a multinational corporation.
3. The ____ consists of different departments such as Finance, Marketing, and IT.
4. In our organization, the ____ ensures that employees know whom to report to.
5. The ____ leads a small group of developers within the IT Department.

6. Our headquarters is _____ in Vietnam, but we have offices worldwide.
7. The company's values and working environment are part of its _____.
8. The HR Department, _____ (who/which/that) handles recruitment, reports directly to the CEO.
9. The finance team _____ (handle) budgeting and payroll for the entire company. (*Use present simple.*)
10. The company has a flexible work policy, _____ (who/which/that) allows employees to work remotely.

WORD BANK:

head of	team leader	corporate division	subsidiary
locate	headquarters	reporting structure	company culture

2. Read the text in pairs and find all words that contain the sounds /dʒ/, /ʒ/, /tʃ/.

At Bridgewell Technologies, we take great pride in maintaining a company culture that encourages collaboration, innovation, and mutual respect. Our management recognises that each individual brings unique strengths, and we aim to create an environment where those strengths can flourish.

One of our central values is open communication. We encourage colleagues to exchange ideas regularly through team meetings, project briefings, and informal chats in the lounge areas. Managers are trained to provide constructive feedback and to challenge negative behaviours that might damage trust.

Another important aspect of our culture is knowledge sharing. Employees from different regions bring a rich range of experiences, which contributes to our collective growth. We organise regular workshops and training sessions to ensure that our strategies remain fresh and aligned with industry changes.

We also cherish diversity and inclusion. We believe that acknowledging cultural differences and showing genuine interest in one another's background strengthens our corporate community. Our leadership team actively engages in initiatives that promote fairness and equal opportunity.

Overall, our culture is not just a statement on the company website; it is a daily commitment. We judge success not only by achievement, but also by the quality of the journey we take together.

/dʒ/	/ʒ/	/tʃ/

3. Confirming information: Use different ways of confirming the information in the sentences below:

- You work as a developer.
- She manages the training programme.
- They need the figures by tomorrow.
- He's responsible for customer support.
- You're travelling to Paris next week.
- We spoke on the phone last month.

Example: *You work as a developer, right?/ Don't you work as a developer?/ You work as a developer, don't you?*



Production

DISCUSSION: COMPANY'S CULTURE

Work in pairs or groups, discuss the questions below. Give examples from your own workplace or a company you know.

- How would you describe your organization's culture (formal, informal, innovative, strict, open, team-based, etc.)?
- Is your organization hierarchical or flat? How does this structure affect communication?
- What are some advantages and disadvantages of working in a hierarchical structure?
- How does your workplace culture influence decision-making, cooperation, or problem-solving?
- What is one thing you like and one thing you want to change about how your company is organized?

Use linkers to organize your ideas:

- **Adding ideas:** "also", "moreover", "in addition", "furthermore"
- **Giving examples:** "for example", "such as", "for instance"
- **Explaining reasons/results:** "because", "therefore", "as a result", "thus", "so"
- **Contrasting:** "however", "on the other hand", "although", "yet"

Discussion:

- Which parts of describing your organization were easy for you, and which were harder? Why?
- How can clear descriptions of structure or culture help you in real conversations at work?
- What is one thing you want to improve next time when talking about your organization?



Key Vocabulary

Word/Phrase	Use	Example
Company Culture	The values and behaviors of such a company	<i>"Our company culture values innovation."</i>
Corporate Division	A major section within a company	<i>"We operate as a subsidiary of Soft Tech."</i>
Head of	Refers to someone leading a department	<i>"She is the head of Marketing."</i>
Reporting Structure	Defines how roles report to each other	<i>"Our reporting structure is hierarchical."</i>
Subsidiary	A company controlled by a larger family	<i>"We operate as a subsidiary of Soft Tech."</i>
Team Leader	Leads a specific team within a division	<i>"The team leader assigns tasks."</i>



Summary

- ✓ Companies have structured hierarchies with key roles such as CEOs, managers, team leaders, and department heads.
- ✓ Each level has distinct responsibilities that contribute to efficient business operations.
- ✓ Practicing how to explain a company's hierarchy in discussions and presentations helps improve fluency and confidence.
- ✓ Clearly explaining an organization's structure demonstrates professionalism and builds credibility.

Lesson 05

Review 01: Lessons 01 - 04



Review Questions

Discussion:

1. What are some formal and informal ways to greet someone in a professional context?
2. Name three phrases to show interest when networking.
3. How is networking different in high-context compared to low-context cultures? Give examples.
4. What are examples of safe (and taboo) topics in certain cultures?
5. In your country, what is considered polite or impolite when starting a business conversation?
6. What is one cultural greeting custom you should know when meeting someone from another country?
7. What are common organizational structures you've learned about?
8. Name two ways to confirm information (e.g., using tag questions).
9. What do hierarchical and flat structures mean? Which is more common in your industry?
10. What linking expressions can you use to structure a short talk about your company?
11. Give one example sentence describing your company's culture.
12. How would you describe your job role and department to a new colleague?



Grammar Review

1. Simple Present Tense

- **Use:** Describe facts, routines, and processes
- **Examples:**
 - ✓ *The server updates its software automatically every night.*

2. Passive Voice

- **Use:** Emphasize processes and results instead of the performer.
- **Structure:** [Object] + is/ are + past participle
- **Examples:**
 - ✓ *The code for the new application is written by the developer.*
 - ✓ *The servers' performance is continuously monitored by the system administrator.*

3. Relative Clauses for Describing Roles and Departments

- **Use:** Provide extra details about IT roles, processes, or systems
- **Examples:**
 - ✓ *The system architect, who designs the network infrastructure, ensures that the data flow is secure and efficient.*
 - ✓ *The testing department, which validates the software's functionality, identifies and reports any bugs before the release.*

Use who (for people), that/which (for things), and commas to add other details.

4. Complex Sentences for Professionalism

- **Use:** connect multiple ideas logically in emails, reports, and presentations
- **Examples:**
 - ✓ *Although the project manager coordinates with various departments, such as Software Testing and Network Engineering, the reporting structure dictates that all technical issues must first be escalated to the Department Head, who then assigns resources accordingly.*

5. Conjunctions (e.g., because, although, since) improve clarity in explanations.



Listening

Listen to the talk and answer the following questions

1. Who is speaking in the recording?

- A. The CEO of BrightTech Solutions
- B. The marketing manager of BrightTech Solutions
- C. The HR manager of BrightTech Solutions
- D. A client from Japan

2. What type of organizational structure does BrightTech have?

- A. Hierarchical
- B. Flat
- C. Matrix
- D. High-context

3. Which of the following etiquette rules is mentioned for Japan?

- A. Avoid eye contact
- B. Shake hands firmly
- C. Exchange business cards with both hands
- D. Use first names

4. How does the speaker usually greet people in Europe and the US?

- A. By bowing
- B. By a handshake
- C. By cheek kissing
- D. By waving

5. What is the speaker's main message about networking?

- A. It should be quick and informal
- B. It depends only on personal preference
- C. It should be respectful and culturally aware
- D. It should avoid professional topics



Practice

1. Role-Play: Quick Networking

Work in pairs and role-play 1-2 business scenarios using relevant key phrases. You can repeat with a new partner and new card or switch role after each round.

Useful phrases:

- *"I'm responsible for..."*
- *"I'd like to introduce..."*
- *"Nice to meet you. What do you do at [company]?"*
- *"Where are you based?"*
- *"How's your current project going?"*

Scenarios:

1. You're meeting a new client at a conference. Introduce yourself and ask a question about their company.
2. A new colleague joins your team. Greet them, introduce your role, and ask about their experience.
3. You're starting a meeting. Introduce yourself and give a quick overview of the agenda.
4. You're at a networking lunch. Ask polite small talk questions about location, travel, or recent events.
5. You've just been introduced to someone from another department during a company event. Ask them about their role, team, and current project.

2. Mini Debate – “Agree or Disagree?”

Work in pairs or small groups and choose 1-2 business opinions below. Decide if you agree or disagree, and explain why. Use examples from your experience.

Statements:

1. “**Introductions** in meetings should always be short.”
2. “**Networking online** is more effective than networking face-to-face.”
3. “**Organizational charts** are not important; people just work together anyway.”
4. “**Small talk** wastes time in business meetings.”
5. “In international teams, it’s better to avoid **personal topics**.”

Useful language:

- “*I agree because...*” / “*I disagree because...*”
- “*That’s an interesting point, but I think...*”
- “*Can you give an example?*”
- “*In my experience...*”
- “*What do you think about...?*”

Audio Transcript

“Good morning, it’s a pleasure to meet you. My name’s Alex Green, and I work as the marketing manager at BrightTech Solutions.

Let me tell you a bit about my company. BrightTech has a flat organizational structure, which means there are only a few layers of management. Teams work closely together and make decisions more quickly. We find that this helps us to be more creative and respond faster to clients.

Our headquarters are in Berlin, but we have offices in three other countries: the United States, Singapore, and Japan. Each location has its own way of doing business, so cultural awareness is very important to us. When I visit our partners in Japan, for example, I always make sure to follow their business etiquette. This includes arriving exactly on time, exchanging business cards with both hands, and addressing people by their family name plus the honorific “-san.” Our Singapore office, on the other hand, is a mix of different traditions, so greetings can vary depending on the person’s background.

Networking is a key part of my role. At events, I usually start with a handshake in Europe and the US, but in Japan, a bow is more common. I like to ask polite questions about the other person’s work and show genuine interest, while avoiding topics that could be too personal or sensitive. I believe that respectful and culturally aware networking builds stronger business relationships — and that’s what we aim for at BrightTech.”

Lesson 06

Describing Your Project



Role-Play

Two IT professionals, Alex (the Project Manager) and Jamie (the IT Specialist), are discussing an ongoing IT project involving the development of a new cloud-based software application.

Alex: Hi Jamie, could you give me a quick update on our **cloud-based software project**?

Jamie: Sure! We're on schedule to meet our first **milestone** next week. The user interface is almost complete.

Alex: Great! Are there any important **deliverables** for this phase?

Jamie: Yes, we need to finalize the **prototype** and conduct initial **encryption** tests to ensure our data security.

Alex: Good thinking about **cybersecurity**. Have we considered feedback from our stakeholders?

Jamie: Yes, they want to ensure that our cloud-based application supports **real-time collaboration** securely.

Alex: What about the project scope? Do we need any adjustments?

Jamie: The scope is still on track, but we need to monitor any additions carefully to avoid **scope creep**.

Alex: Agreed. Let's make sure everything aligns with our project goals and stays within the timeline.

Jamie: Absolutely! I'll also prepare a risk assessment regarding **third-party integrations**.

Alex: Perfect! Thanks for the update, Jamie.

Role-play analysis

1. What challenges were identified in the conversation regarding the project?
2. What steps did Jamie mention to ensure stakeholder needs were met?
3. What risks were identified throughout the conversation?
4. What strategies did they discuss to ensure the project stays on track?
5. Why was cybersecurity highlighted in their discussion?



Stressed Syllables

Practice pronouncing these words with the correct stress:

- | | |
|----------------------------------|-------------------------|
| 1. MILE stone | /ˈmaɪl.stoʊn/ |
| 2. De LI verable | /dɪˈlɪv.ər.ə.bəl/ |
| 3. STAKE holder | /ˈsteɪk.hoʊldər/ |
| 4. Scope | /skoʊp/ |
| 5. TIME line | /ˈtaɪm.laɪn/ |
| 6. PRO totype | /ˈproʊ.toʊ.taɪp/ |
| 7. Cyberse CU rity | /ˌsaɪ.bər.sɪˈkjʊr.ɪ.ti/ |
| 8. En CRY ption | /ɪnˈkrɪp.ʃən/ |



Project Elements and Common Phrases

PROJECT ELEMENTS	DESCRIPTION	COMMON PHRASES
Project Title	Name of the Project	“Our project is named...” “I’m working on the project called...”
Goals and Objectives	What you aim to achieve with this project	“The primary goal of this project is to...” “We aim to achieve the following objectives...”
Key Milestones	Significant stages of the project and their completion dates	“Key milestones for this project include...” “The significant phases of the project are...”
Team and Stakeholders	Who is involved in the project	“The project team consists of...” “Key stakeholders involved in this project are...”
Deliverables	The products or results the will project produce	“Expected outcomes include...” “The project will produce...”
Challenges and Solutions	The challenges you faced, and how you overcame them.	“We faced several challenges, including...” “To overcome these challenges, we implemented...”
Current Status	Where you are now in the project timeline	“Currently, we have completed...” “The present status of the project is...”



Practice

Read the passage aloud in pairs, taking turns reading the passage. Listen carefully to your partner and give constructive feedback on pronunciation, stress, and clarity.

Passage 1: My Role as an I.T. Project Coordinator

I work as an I.T. Project coordinator in a software company. My main responsibility is to manage each **milestone** and make sure that every **deliverable** meets quality standards. I work closely with every **stakeholder** to clearly define the project scope at the beginning of the process. During the project, I regularly review the **timeline** and adjust tasks when necessary to avoid delays. I also organize meetings, prepare reports, and support communication between technical and non-technical teams. I enjoy my job because it allows me to solve problems, manage priorities, and help projects succeed.

Passage 2: My Job in Software Development and Cybersecurity

I work as a software developer with a strong focus on system security. At the start of each project, I help design and test a **prototype** to check functionality and performance. I also create a detailed **timeline** to plan each stage of development and track progress. A key part of my role is **cybersecurity**, especially protecting systems and user data. I use **encryption** to secure information and reduce the risk of cyber-attacks. I also review code, fix bugs, and improve system stability. I like my job because I work with modern technologies and contribute to building safe and reliable software.

Criteria		Comments
Clarity	- Are the words pronounced clearly enough to understand? - Are long or technical words pronounced clearly?	
Stress	Are the correct syllables and important words emphasized?	
Intonation	Does the voice rise/fall at appropriate places?	
Pace	Is the reading speed appropriate (e.g. not too fast or too slow)?	
Pausing	- Are pauses placed in the right spots (commas, periods, natural breaks), or placed in random places? - Are pauses too long or too short?	



Production

DESCRIBING YOUR IT PROJECT

Instructions:

- Work in pairs.
- Describe a project you have worked on or are currently working on.

Project Description Template:

- **Project Title**
 - **Goals and Objectives**
 - **Key Milestones**
 - **Team and Stakeholders**
 - **Deliverables**
 - **Challenges and Solutions**
 - **Current Status**
- Focus on clarity and organization in your descriptions.
 - Present your project descriptions to the class.

Discussion

1. Why is conducting a risk assessment crucial for projects?
2. How do you often communicate with your team?
3. How can we ensure the quality of our deliverables?
4. What criteria should we use to set milestones in our project?
5. What is one key lesson you've learned from past projects that we should keep in mind?



Key Vocabulary

TERMS	BRIEF DEFINITION	EXAMPLES
Cloud-based	Software or services hosted on remote servers and accessed via the internet.	<i>Google Drive, Dropbox, and Microsoft 365 are cloud-based applications.</i>
Cybersecurity	The practice of protecting systems, networks, and data from digital attacks.	<i>Firewalls, antivirus software, and data encryption measures enhance cybersecurity.</i>
Encryption	The process of converting data into a coded format to prevent unauthorized access.	<i>Sensitive information like credit card numbers is often encrypted during online transactions.</i>
Prototype	A preliminary version of a product used for testing and feedback.	<i>The team created a prototype of the app to demonstrate its features and gather user feedback.</i>
Deliverable	A specific outcome or tangible result produced as part of a project.	<i>A completed software application version is a deliverable in a development project.</i>
Scope Creep	The uncontrolled expansion of project requirements beyond the original plan.	<i>Adding new features to an application after the project timeline has been set can lead to scope creep.</i>
Integration	The process of combining different systems or software to work together seamlessly.	<i>We completed the integration of our new CRM system with our email marketing platform to streamline communications.</i>

Lesson 07

Explaining Process



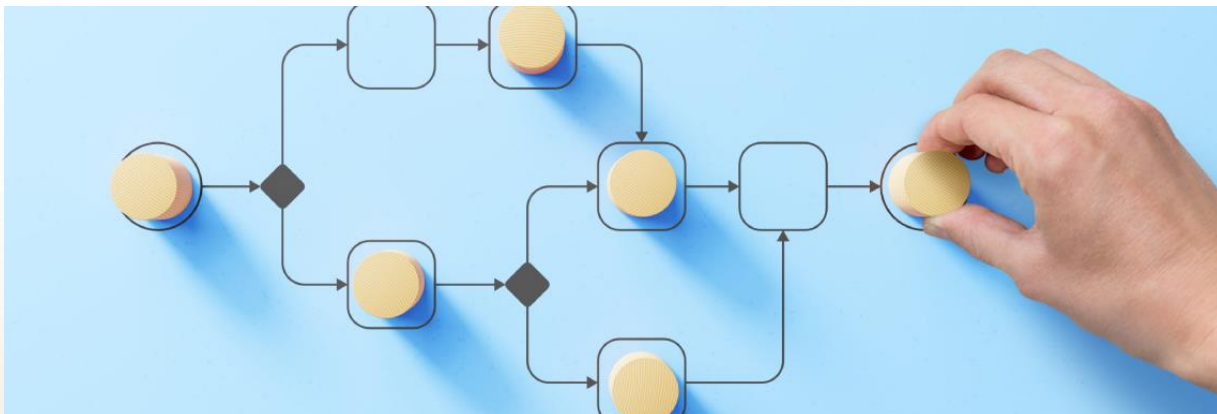
Warm-up

Work with a partner and discuss the stages for one of the following processes:

1. Applying for a job
2. Enrolling in school/ a training program
3. Onboarding at a workplace
4. Purchasing a house
5. Opening a bank account

Discussion:

- Why did you do this process?
- Who were involved in the process?
- What were the steps for this process?





Role-Play

Scenario: Anna from the HR department is explaining a process to Tom, a new employee.

Anna: *Let me explain how* we request paid leave in the company. **Essentially, there are three main steps** you need to follow. **It's also worth noting** that the system updates every 24 hours, so your request might not appear right away.

Tom: Okay, thanks. I'm listening.

Anna: **First, begin by** logging into the employee portal with your username and password. **Next**, go to the "Leave Requests" section and select "Paid Leave." **Then**, choose the start and end dates of your leave. **Finally, once you've completed** the form, submit it online.

Tom: **Sorry, did you say** I should choose the dates before submitting the form?

Anna: Yes, exactly. You must select the leave dates before you click "Submit." Shortly afterwards, it sends your request to your manager for approval.

Tom: **Let me check I've understood you correctly.** After I submit, I just wait for approval, right?

Anna: Yes, that's correct. Once the manager approves, you'll get a confirmation email from the system within 24 hours.

Role-play Analysis

- What process is described?
- How many main steps are there?
- Why might the request not appear in the system immediately?
- How will Tom know that his request has been approved?

Discussion

- Why do you think it is important to use sequencing words when explaining a process?
- Do you usually check your understanding or ask for clarification in a conversation?
- If you were explaining another process at workplace, which phrases from the dialogue could you reuse?



Vocabulary

Key phrases	Examples/Responses
1. Giving simple explanations:	
- Let me explain how we ... - Essentially, there are ... main steps/ stages. - It's also worth noting that ... - The basic process is ...	Let me explain how we process customer requests. Essentially, there are three main stages in the approval workflow. It's also worth noting that the system updates every 24 hours.
2. Sequencing:	
- First, Next, Then, Finally. - Initially, Subsequently, Eventually - Begin/Start/Finish by doing something ... - Once/Now/After/When you've done something ...	Initially, we meet with the team to explain the project goals. Let's begin by logging into the system. Once you've completed the form, submit it online.
3. Clarifying:	
- Let me check I've understood you correctly. - Do you mean ...? - Sorry, did you say ...? - So, are you saying that ...? - What do you mean by ...?	Responses: - Yes, you've got it. - Not exactly. What I mean is ... - Almost. Let me clarify that ... - Let me give you more details ... - To put it another way ...
4. Checking understanding:	
- Do you know what I mean? - Is that clear? - Does that make sense? - Do you have any questions?	Responses: - Absolutely - I see what you mean. - I don't get ... - Kind of, but ...



Practice

1. Listen to the recording describing a process and number these steps in the correct order 1-4:

Basic IT Troubleshooting Procedure

- _____ restart your computer to refresh the settings.
- _____ contact the IT department if the problem continues.
- _____ make sure your device is connected to the correct network.
- _____ run a diagnostic check to identify any issues.

2. Work with a partner. Take turns to explain the trouble shooting process again using the key phrases in the listening exercise.

What are key expressions used in each step?

Introduction	e.g. <i>Let me explain how we ...</i>
Step 1	
Step 2	
Step 3	
Step 4	



Production

ROLE-PLAY: PRESENT A PROCESS

Work in pairs and choose a role to present a process. Switch roles and present a new process if time allows.

Role A: Team leader	Role B: Team member
- Explain a process clearly. - Clarify and check understanding when your team member asks questions.	- Listen to the explanation. - Ask clarifying questions.

You may present a process from **your own department**, or **choose one** from the list below:

1. Engineering/ Product Design: Creating coordinates for parts of a turbine blade in CAD software Identify parts: Determine which blade sections need coordinates Gather specifications: Dimensions, angles, materials Open CAD software: Load project file/template Set coordinate system: Define X/Y/Z axis reference points Create part geometry: Draw shapes using measurements Assign coordinates: Input exact points for each part Save project: Use company format/naming convention Export files: For manufacturing or simulation team	2. IT Project: Deploying a new software version to the test server Review release notes: Understand updates and fixes Check test environment: Server status, disk space, backups Download new version: Secure connection from repository Stop old service: Temporarily disable existing version Install update: Run installer scripts / configure settings Run tests: Automated unit testing and manual checks Document results: Record any issues or bugs found Confirm deployment: Notify project team it's ready for review
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3. HR Process: Hiring a new social media coordinator 1. Define job role: Responsibilities, required skills 2. Create job posting: Clear description, company branding 3. Publish advertisement: Job boards, LinkedIn, internal site 4. Collect applications: Track in HR system 5. Screen candidates: Review CVs, shortlist applicants 6. Schedule interviews: Contact shortlisted candidates 7. Select final candidate: Evaluate interview performance 8. Send offer: Prepare contract, confirm start date	4. Marketing Campaign: Launching a new product social media campaign 1. Set campaign objectives: Goals, target audience, key message 2. Research audience: Demographics, interests, preferred platforms 3. Create content plan: Types of posts, posting schedule, hashtags 4. Design visuals & copy: Graphics, videos, captions aligned with brand 5. Schedule posts: Use social media tools (e.g., Hootsuite, Buffer) 6. Launch campaign: Publish first posts across selected platforms 7. Monitor performance: Check engagement rates, comments, shares 8. Adjust strategy: Update content based on audience response and analytics
--	--

Discussion

1. What part of the process explanation was most challenging for you (e.g. thinking of steps, using vocabulary, or answering clarification questions)?
2. How did sequencing help you explain the process?
3. Did your partner's clarifying questions make your explanation clearer? Give one example.
4. How can you use the expressions from today's lesson in your real workplace conversations?

Lesson 08

Cross-Cultural Skills



Warm-Up

Discussion

1. **What should you be aware of when working with people from different cultures?**
 - Language
 - Gestures and body language
 - Social behavior
 - Relationship between colleagues and clients
 - Attitudes to time management
 - Others
2. **Why do you think these factors are important in a business context?**



Video

1. **Watch Part 1 of the interview with Michael Dickmann, a senior lecturer at Cranfield University, School of Management, talking about cultural differences in business.**

As you watch, answer the following questions:

1. Is it important for companies to be aware of cultural differences? Why?
2. What might a British person mean if they say, "It's not too bad"?
3. What might a German person think it means?
4. What might a Nigerian company describe giving money to get something? What about a western company?

Discussion

- Can you think of a time when a misunderstanding happened because of cultural differences? What happened?

2. Watch Part 2 of the interview, where Michael discusses power distance, one of the most noticeable cultural differences in business context. Fill in the blanks with the following words in the box:

a. can't say <i>"I just did it because my boss said I should do it"</i> .	b. won't disagree with your boss.	c. won't critic your boss.
d. can speak up against your boss.	e. will do what your boss tells you to do.	f. need to speak up when your boss gives you a task or request.

High power distance	Low power distance
If you come from a high power distance culture, you _____	If you come from a low power distance culture, you _____
Examples of high power distance countries: Japan, Brazil, Venezuela	Examples of low power distance countries: Denmark, Sweden, Holland

Discussion:

- Do you come from a country with high or low power distance? Give an explanation.
- Do you know any other country with the same or opposite culture as yours?
- Can you share an example of a situation where cultural differences in power distance led to misunderstandings in the workplace?



Practice

Discussion: Speaking Across Cultures - High vs. Low Power Distance

- Work in pairs or small groups.
- For each business situation, decide which phrase comes from a high or low power distance culture.
- Discuss which phrase you would use when working with:

☐ Your manager	☐ Your clients	☐ Your colleagues
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1. Giving instructions or tasks

A: "Please follow my directions."

B: "Feel free to suggest a different approach."

2. Disagreeing with someone

A: "I see your point, but could we consider a different solution?"

B: "I understand, I will do it as you say."

3. Asking for feedback

A: "I appreciate your guidance."

B: "I'd like your honest opinion."

4. Making decisions

A: "I'll wait for management to decide."

B: "Let's find a way that works for both of us."

Discussion:

- Which phrases can you use in your own culture?
- Do you think using the opposite style would be comfortable or challenging for you? Why?
- Would you change your approach depending on who you're speaking to (manager, client, or colleague)? How?



Production

Cultural Scenarios: What Would You Do?

1. Work in pairs or small groups and choose one scenario from the list below.
2. Discuss the situation together and prepare a short response (1–2 minutes) showing how you would handle it in a respectful and culturally sensitive way.
3. Present your response to the class.
4. Classmates give brief feedback: “Was it culturally appropriate? Why or why not?”

Scenarios:

- You're in a virtual meeting with a client. They remain silent for a long time after you ask a question. Do you move on or wait?
- A colleague gives you very direct feedback. You feel it's too blunt. What do you do?
- You invite a new coworker to a casual Friday lunch, but they seem unsure or hesitant to accept. How do you respond?
- During a group project, your teammate talks a lot and often interrupts. How do you manage this dynamic?



Key Vocabulary

Word/Phrase	Use	Example
Culture	The beliefs, customs, and social behavior of a particular group or society.	<i>In Japanese culture, bowing is a common way to show respect.</i>
Cultural Differences	The ways in which cultures vary from one another in beliefs, behaviors, and communication styles.	<i>Cultural differences can affect how managers give feedback in international teams.</i>
Ethics and values	Principles and standards that guide behavior and decision-making within a society or organization.	<i>Our company's ethics and values emphasize honesty and respect for all employees.</i>
Power Distance	The extent to which less powerful members of organizations accept and expect unequal power distribution.	<i>In high power distance cultures, employees rarely question their managers' decisions.</i>
Norms	Accepted standards of behavior or ways of doing things in a particular group or society.	<i>In many countries, shaking hands is the social norm when meeting new business partners.</i>
Etiquette	The rules of polite behavior in a society or group.	<i>Good table etiquette is important during a business dinner in France.</i>



Wrap-Up

“To effectively communicate, we must realize that we are all different in the way we perceive the world.”

Why is it important to adapt our communication style when working with international colleagues?

Lesson 09

Cross-cultural Business Situations



Case study

The Delayed Launch (Voice Recording Transcript)

Catalyst Creative Solutions, an IT company based in the United States, was contracted by Kaito Electronics, a Japanese company, to develop a new cloud-based data management system. The initial project deadline was set for three months.

The U.S. team, accustomed to direct communication and frequent updates, sent daily emails detailing their progress and highlighting any potential roadblocks. They also scheduled weekly video conferences to discuss the project.

Kaito Electronics, however, preferred less frequent communication and valued a more hierarchical decision-making process. They found the daily emails overwhelming and the direct questions during the video conferences somewhat abrupt. They also expected a more formal, detailed report closer to the deadline.

As the deadline approached, Kaito Electronics expressed concern about the project's progress, citing a lack of detailed documentation and a perceived lack of understanding of their specific needs. The U.S. team, confused by the client's sudden dissatisfaction, pointed to the daily emails and weekly meetings as evidence of their consistent communication.

Ultimately, the project launch was delayed by two weeks, leading to frustration on both sides. The U.S. team felt their efforts were unappreciated, while Kaito Electronics felt their communication preferences and cultural expectations were disregarded.

Case study analysis:

1. What contributed to the project's delay?
2. What did the U.S. team send to the client during the project?
3. Why did Kaito Electronics think the U.S. team's communication was a problem?
4. How was Kaito Electronics' preferred way of working different from the U.S. team's way?
5. What could the U.S. team and Kaito Electronics have done earlier to understand each other better?



Communication Essentials

1. Do Your Research:

- Before interacting, learn about the client's or team's culture.
- Focus on communication styles, formality, and expectations.

2. Communicate Clearly and Respectfully:

- Avoid jargon and use simple language.
- Be mindful of body language (even in video calls).
- Ask clarifying questions to ensure mutual understanding.

3. Build Relationships:

- Take time to establish trust. Show genuine interest in learning about their culture.
- Be patient and understanding.

4. Adapt Your Approach:

- Be flexible and willing to adjust your communication and work style.
- Be open to feedback and learn from your mistakes.

5. Clarify Expectations:

- Explicitly discuss deadlines, communication frequency, and project goals upfront.
- Use phrases like “Let's clarify expectations” to avoid misunderstandings.

6. Understand Negotiation Styles:

- Be aware that “different cultures have different approaches to negotiations.”
- Be prepared to adapt your negotiation tactics.

In essence:

- Listen actively.
- Be aware of your own cultural biases.
- Show respect.
- Be flexible.



Pronunciation: Linking sounds

1. **Definition:** Linking sounds is when the end sound of one word connects to the beginning sound of the next word in a sentence, creating a smoother, more natural flow, often making words sound like one.
2. **Common Pattern:** One of the most frequent ways we link sounds in English is **consonant - vowel**. This happens when a consonant at the end of a word linked to a vowel sound at the start of the next word.

Listen to the examples and repeat:

- Look_at that! Breakfast_in bed!
- A: Bought_it? B: No, caught_it!
- That's_enough! Switch_it_off!

3. Listening tips:

- The letter **h** at the beginning of *he*, *his*, *her* and *him* is often not pronounced so the first sound in these words is often a vowel sound. For examples:
 - My husband's forgotten **n**_(h)is passport.
 - I haven't seen **n**_(h)er.
- Where there's a /t/ sound before a vowel, some people don't pronounce the /t/ clearly.
 - switch **t**_(i) off
 - drink **k**_(i) up
 - can'(t) agree

4. Practice: Work in pairs/group and mark where you think there will be links between consonants and vowels.

- Choose the correct **t**_(a)nswer and tick it.
- Which page is it on?
- How do you spell it?
- How do you pronounce it?
- What does it mean?
- I can't understand this.
- Look it up in your dictionary.

Listen to check your answers, then, practice these sentences with your partner.



Practice

Debate: Agree or Disagree?

Work in pairs and small groups and choose one of the following topics to discuss whether you agree or disagree with it:

1. Cultural differences always make teamwork more difficult.
2. The best teams are made of people from similar cultures.
3. Good communication is more important than technical skills when working in an international team.
4. It is the responsibility of the newcomer to adapt to the company's culture, not the other way around.
5. In business, efficiency is more important than respecting cultural traditions.

Useful phrases:

- **Stating your opinion:**
 - *From my perspective/ experience, ...*
 - *It seems to me that ...*
 - *As far as I'm concerned, ...*
- **Agreeing:**
 - *I agree with you because...,*
 - *I think we have the same idea.*
 - *That's a good point.*
- **Disagreeing:**
 - *I'm not sure that's always the case.*
 - *Don't get me wrong, but I don't think that's true in every situation.*
 - *I understand your view, but I have a different idea.*



Production

DISCUSSION: CULTURAL DIFFERENCES AT WORK

Work with a partner or in small groups. Take turns and share your personal experience where cultural differences (i.e. between countries, regions, professional backgrounds, etc.) influenced communication or teamwork.

**Note: If you have no personal experience, you may use an example you learned from someone else, read about, or saw online.*

Follow this outline for your sharing:

- Describe the **cultural difference** (see the list of possible situations).
- Explain how it **positively or negatively** impacted communication or teamwork.
- Share what was **learned** or how you/others adapted to **improve cooperation**.

Possible Situations

1. Communication Style

- Direct language vs. polite/indirect language.
- Some people want a lot of small talk, others want to start the meeting quickly.
- Different body language (eye contact, gestures, facial expressions).

2. Time & Deadlines

- Arriving early vs. arriving “on time” or later.
- Deadlines are fixed vs. deadlines are flexible.

3. Decision-Making

- Quick, individual decisions vs. slow, group decisions.
- Boss decides everything vs. team decides together.

4. Meetings & Participation

- Speaking often in meetings vs. speaking only when asked.
- Interrupting to give ideas vs. waiting for your turn.

5. Hierarchy & Formality

- First names for everyone vs. using titles (Mr./Ms./Dr.).
- Giving clear, direct feedback vs. giving very soft, indirect suggestions.

6. Written Communication

- Short and simple emails vs. long and detailed emails.
- Using emojis or informal style vs. keeping it very formal.

Discussion

- What was the most interesting cultural difference you heard about today? Why?
- If this situation happened to you in the future, what would you do differently?
- What skills or strategies can help you work well with people from different cultures?



Key Vocabulary

Word/Phrase	Use	Example
Negotiation styles	The varying approaches used when discussing to reach an agreement.	<i>Different cultures have different approaches to negotiations.</i>
Formality levels	The degree to which formal language and behavior are used.	<i>Understanding formality levels is essential when communicating with clients from different cultures.</i>
International mindset	A global perspective and openness to diverse cultures.	<i>Developing an international mindset is crucial for success in global IT projects.</i>
Build cross-cultural trust	To establish confidence and reliability with people from different cultural backgrounds.	<i>Consistent and transparent communication helps build cross-cultural trust.</i>
Let's clarify expectations to avoid misunderstandings.	An expression used to ensure mutual understanding and prevent potential issues.	<i>To ensure a smooth project, let's clarify expectations to avoid misunderstandings.</i>
Different cultures have different approaches to negotiations.	An expression acknowledging the diversity in how agreements are reached across cultures.	<i>Different cultures have different approaches to negotiations, so it's important to be flexible.</i>

Lesson 10

Review Lessons 06 - 09



Review Discussion

1. How would you briefly introduce your project to a new team member?
2. Explain one process in your work using sequencing language (First, Next, Then, Finally).
3. Give two phrases you can use to check understanding during an explanation.
4. Describe one problem your project faced and how your team handled it.
5. How would you clarify if someone didn't understand your explanation?
6. Give one example of high power-distance behavior and one example of low power-distance behavior.
7. Describe a situation where cultural differences might cause misunderstandings at work.
8. Which communication style is more common in your company/project?
9. How would you adjust your communication when speaking with someone from a higher-power-distance culture?
10. If a colleague avoids saying "no" directly, what strategies can you use to clarify their meaning?



Practice

1. Discussion: Cross-Cultural Scenarios - What Would You Do?

In small groups, read short descriptions of cultural situations that happen during international IT projects. Your task is to discuss:

- What could be the cultural issue here?
- How would you respond professionally?

Scenario 1:

You're on a Zoom call with your new client in Japan. After presenting your proposal, you ask if they agree. They respond with silence and a slight smile.

- What might this mean? What should you do next?

Scenario 2:

You send a detailed 8-paragraph email to a colleague in the U.S. They reply with one sentence.

- Are they being rude? How would you follow up?

Scenario 3:

During a daily Scrum meeting, your colleague from Sweden openly criticizes a bug you missed.

- How would you react constructively?

2. Pronunciation: Linking sounds

1. Common pattern: Another common pattern of linking sounds is **vowel - vowel**. We use /j/ and /w/ to link a vowel sound at the end of a word with a vowel sound at the beginning of the next word.

- a. /j/: If the first word ends with a vowel sound like /ɪ/ or /i:/, and the next word starts with any vowel sound, we use /j/ to link the words.

Examples:

- me_jand you
- three_jor four
- the_jend

- b. /w/: If the first word ends with a vowel sound like /ʊ/ or /u:/, and the next word starts with any vowel sound, we use /w/ to link the words.

Examples:

- you_wand me
- two_wor three
- go_woutside

2. Practice: Listen and complete the dialogues: Then mark the /j/ and /w/ links:

1. **A:** Do you ^w often go swimming?
B: Not really, I _____ or twice a month.
2. **A:** What's _____ letter in the alphabet?
B: Maybe it's G or H _____?
3. **A:** When do _____ holiday?
B: We _____ July or August.
4. **A:** What's your _____?
B: Twenty-eight, Sea Avenue.
5. **A:** Try _____ soon.
B: OK, I'll send you my answer _____.
6. **A:** Look! There's _____ the mountains.
B: Really? I can't _____.



Production

Debate: Project Decision – Should We Launch Now or Delay?

Context:

Your company has been developing a new product for 6 months. The deadline is in one month.

- Some team members think launching as soon as possible will give a competitive advantage.
- Others think you need more time to test and improve quality.

The CEO wants advice. **Should you launch now or delay the project?**

1. Choose a role and develop these 3 arguments to support your opinion:

Role A: Team Launch	Role B: Team Delay
- We can be first in the market and beat competitors. - We will start making profit sooner. - We have already spent a lot of time and money, so we should get results.	- We need more testing to avoid mistakes. - We can improve quality before release. - A delay might lead to higher customer satisfaction in the long term.

2. Debate Structure:

- Opening Statements:** Each team has 1 minute to speak.
- Rebuttal & Counterarguments:** Each team responds to the other's points (2–3 minutes total).
- Open Floor Discussion:** Both sides can ask questions or challenge (3–4 minutes).
- Closing Statements:** Each team summarizes why your decision is better (1 minute per team).
- Vote:** The whole class decides who had the strongest arguments.

3. Useful phrases:

- Giving Opinions:** “I think the best option is...”, “It might be better to...”, “From a business perspective...”
- Agreeing:** “I completely agree with your point about...”
- Disagreeing politely:** “I see your point, but I’m not sure I agree because...”
- Project Vocabulary:** deadline, budget, risk assessment, quality control, stakeholder satisfaction, resources, objectives.

Discussion:

- Did you change your opinion during the debate? What persuaded you?
- What new vocabulary or expressions did you use in the debate?
- If you could do the debate again, what would you do differently?

Lesson 11

Updating and Delegating Tasks



Warm-Up

Task Delegation Discussion

- Have you ever had to delegate a task? How did you do it?
- Tell which task(s) you would delegate and to whom.



Role-Play

Scenario: Emma, a project manager, is delegating a task to Tom, a software developer. Later, Tom provides an update on his progress.

Emma: Hi Tom, could you take care of testing the new feature before Friday?

Tom: Sure, I can do that. Do you need a detailed report on the test results?

Emma: Yes, please. Make sure to check for any security issues and report any bugs.

Tom: Got it. I'll start today and keep you updated.

(Later in the week...)

Emma: Hi Tom, how is the testing going?

Tom: I've completed most of the tests, but I found a security issue that needs to be fixed. It might take an extra day to resolve.

Emma: Thanks for the update. Let me know when it's fixed.

Tom: Will do!

Role-play Analysis

1. What task did Emma delegate to Tom?
2. What instructions did Emma give about the task?
3. How did Tom update Emma about the task's progress?
4. What issue did Tom find during testing?
5. How did Emma respond to the update?

Discussion

- What challenges do you face when delegating tasks or updating progress in English?



Grammar

1. Present Perfect for Progress Updates - *has/have + past participle*

Examples: We **have finished** testing the new feature.

2. Present Continuous for Ongoing Work – *is/are + verb (-ing)*

Examples: I **am working** on the final section of the report.

3. Future Form for Deadlines - *will or going to + base verb*

Examples: The team **is going** to submit the final draft tomorrow.



Key Phrases

Asking for an update	Giving an update
• Can you update me on ...? • What's the progress on ...? • How's everything going? • What's happening with ...? • Where are we with ...?	• We've done / finished / completed ... • So far, so good. • Everything's on track. • We're currently (verb + -ing) ...

Delegating - Is that something you can help with? - Can anyone else help you? - Would you like to help with that? - I'd like you to help with ... - Yes, no problem. / I'll do it. - Sorry, but ... / I'd do it, but ... / I'm afraid I can't do it.	Summing up the action plan - So, let's check we all know what we're doing ... - You're going to ... and I'm going to ... - Let's meet again in two weeks to review the situation / progress.
--	---



Practice

A. Identification

Instructions: Identify the function of each phrase: **Updating or Delegating**.

Phrase	Function
1. Could you handle the testing process?	
2. The report is almost finished.	
3. We're running behind schedule due to a delay.	
4. I'd like you to take care of this task.	
5. Please make sure to double-check the data.	
6. The team has already completed the first phase.	
7. I'll need you to finish this by tomorrow.	
8. The update is taking longer than expected.	
9. Can you give me a status update?	
10. There's a small issue, but we're working on it.	

B. Listening

1. Ramon is leading his department meeting. Listen to part of the meeting and complete his notes on the discussion.

Recruitment

- Update (1): They have recruited frontline staff but they need to interview for the post of manager.
- When: (2) _____
- Problem: Sue needs (3) _____
- Action: Eloise will (4) _____

Induction training

- Update (5): Xavier scheduled induction training for new frontline staff.
- When: (6) _____
- Problem: (7) _____
- Action: (8) _____

2. Look at these expressions from the meeting. Listen again and number the expressions 1–12 in the order you hear them.

- __1__ Can you update me on that?
- __ Sorry, but I've never run induction training before.
- __ Eloise is going to interview with Sue.
- __ Is that something you can help with?
- __ Let's check we all know what we're doing.
- __ What's happening with that?
- __ Can anyone else help you?
- __ I'd like you to help if possible.
- __ Would you like to help with that?
- __ Yes, no problem.
- __ I'd do it, but I'm away as well that week.
- __ Let's meet again in three weeks' time.



Production

PROGRESS UPDATES AND TASK DELEGATION

1. Work in pairs (Manager & Employee).
2. Switch roles after each round.

Scenario 1: Task Delegation

Manager: Assign a report-writing task to your team member. Include details (deadline, key points to cover, format).

Employee: Ask for clarification if needed and confirm understanding.

Manager	Employee
Assign a sales performance report for the monthly meeting.	Usually work with Excel, not PowerPoint.
Include: quarterly sales figures, comparison with last year, 2 main factors affecting sales.	Missing last year's comparison data.
Deadline: Wednesday next week.	Ask where to find last year's data and report structure.
Format: company PowerPoint template.	Confirm deadline, format, and key points before starting.
Offer help if needed.	Make sure you understand task clearly.

Scenario 2: Progress Updates

Employee: You are working on a project, and your manager asks for an update. Report your progress, any issues, and estimated completion time.

Manager: Ask follow-up questions and provide feedback.

Manager	Employee
Check status of website redesign project .	Homepage & About Us done; Product pages 50% complete.
Ask: which pages need work, impact of delays.	Waiting for product photos from marketing (delayed).
Event launch in 2 weeks — project must finish before.	Possible 1–2 days late if photos don't arrive soon.
Offer solutions: contact marketing, use placeholder images.	Give realistic completion estimate; explain issues clearly.

Discussion

- *Why is it important to set a deadline when delegating a task?*
- *What strategies can help when facing a delay in completing a task?*
- *Was it difficult to describe your workplace?*



Key Vocabulary

Word/Phrase	Use	Example
Delegate	To assign a task to someone else	<i>I will delegate the report-writing task to Sarah.</i>
Deadline	The final date by which a task must be completed	<i>The deadline for the project is next Friday.</i>
On track	Moving forward as planned or expected	<i>The project is on track for completion next week.</i>

Lesson 12

Managing Tasks



Warm-Up

Quick Discussion

1. Have you ever had to manage several tasks at the same time?
2. How do you decide which task to work on first?
3. What's more important: meeting every deadline or ensuring top quality? Why?



Role-Play

***Scenario:** The manager and Alex (an employee) are talking about prioritising tasks for the week and setting deadlines.*

Manager: Hi Alex, let's review the tasks for this week.

Alex: Sure! I have the list ready.

Manager: Great. This task is **high priority** because it affects the client's deadline.

Handle the urgent tasks first.

Alex: Got it. I'll start with the high-priority items immediately.

Manager: For the database update, we'll **postpone** this to next week since it's **low priority**.

Alex: Okay, I'll **move that to** next week's schedule.

Manager: Perfect. For the marketing report, **let's set a new deadline** for this task – Friday afternoon.

Alex: Understood. I'll make sure it's ready by then.

Manager: Thanks, Alex. Let's keep communication clear so we can stay on track.

Alex: Absolutely! I'll send you updates as I progress.

Role-play Analysis

1. Which task did the manager identify as high priority, and why was it considered urgent?
2. What action did the manager take regarding the database update, and what does this show about prioritization?
3. What new deadline was set during the conversation, and why is setting deadlines important for task management?
4. How did the manager ensure clear communication throughout the discussion and why is this critical for teamwork?

Discussion

- How do clear and concise task updates help in managing tasks effectively and improving teamwork and project efficiency?



Key phrases: Priority

Language for prioritizing tasks

- Let's **review** the tasks for this week/month.
- This task is high/low **priority**.
- We'll **move / postpone** this to next week.
- Handle the **urgent** tasks first.
- Can you **coordinate** with another department/team?
- We need to **address the issue immediately**.
- Let's set a new **deadline** for this task.



Pronunciation

Practice pronouncing these words with the correct stress:

re VIEW	/rɪˈvjuː/
pri OR ity	/praɪˈɔːr.ə.ti/
post PONE	/pɒsˈspɒn/
HAN dle	/ˈhændl/
Ur gent	/ˈɜː.dʒənt/
co OR dinate	/kooˈɔːr.də.neɪt/
Im ME diately	/ɪˈmiː.di.ət.li/



Eisenhower Decision Matrix



1. **Do** (Urgent and Important): Handle immediately
2. **Decide** (Not Urgent but Important): Plan/Schedule for later
3. **Delegate** (Urgent but Not Important): Assign to someone
4. **Delete** (Neither Urgent nor Important): Eliminate or ignore



Practice

PRIORITISING TASKS

Context:

Your team is organising a product launch event. There's no extra staff, but only your team will handle them.

Your job: Sort the 10 tasks into the four Eisenhower Matrix categories immediately, based on urgency and importance from the timetable.

Instructions:

- Work in pairs/ groups.
- Place each task into one of the four matrix quadrants: ***Do, Decide, Delegate, Delete.***
- Use **priority phrases** and **matrix-specific phrases** when discussing.
- Be ready to explain your team's reasoning.

Task list:

1. Finalise the event agenda
2. Order catering for guests
3. Respond to email about printer maintenance
4. Prepare presentation slides for the keynote
5. Upload last month's team-building photos to Instagram
6. Arrange hotel rooms for VIP guests
7. Book the event venue
8. Design event invitations
9. Review company's 5-year strategy plan
10. Water the office plants

Timetable

Task	Week 1	Week 2	Week 3	Week 4	Week 5	Week 6	Week 7	Week 8
Finalize event agenda	■							
Book the event venue	■							
Respond to email about printer maintenance	■							
Arrange hotel rooms for VIP guests		■	■					
Order catering for guests			■	■				
Prepare keynote presentation slides			■	■				
Design event invitations				■	■			
Upload last month's team-building photos					■			
Review company's 5-year strategy plan								■
Water office plants	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■



Production

DISCUSSION

Instructions: Discuss how to manage tasks effectively using the Eisenhower Matrix and share practical examples from your work experience.

1. Why is it important to distinguish between urgent and important tasks when managing your workload?
2. Which quadrant do you think most people spend too much time in, and why?
3. Give an example of a task from your work that belongs in the **“Decide”** quadrant. How would you schedule it?
4. What challenges might you face when delegating tasks from the **“Delegate”** quadrant? How can you overcome them?
5. Why is it necessary to eliminate tasks in the **“Delete”** quadrant, and what impact does this have on productivity?

Discussion

- Why is prioritizing tasks essential for meeting deadlines and maintaining productivity in a busy work environment?



Key Vocabulary

Word	Use	Example
Review	To examine or assess something carefully, often to check for accuracy, quality, or progress.	<i>Let's review the tasks for this week to ensure everything is on track.</i>
Priority	To indicate the level of importance or urgency assigned to a task, issue, or responsibility.	<i>This task is a high priority because it directly impacts the client's deadline.</i>
Postpone	Used when rescheduling tasks, meetings, or events to a future date or time.	<i>We'll postpone the database update to next week since it's low priority.</i>
Urgent	To describe tasks, issues, or situations that cannot be delayed and must be addressed right away.	<i>Responding to a critical issue is an urgent task that needs immediate resolution.</i>

Lesson 13

Making Suggestions and Decisions



Warm-Up

Motivation Questions:

1. What are some ways you suggest ideas during meetings in your office?
2. How are problems usually resolved during a meeting?



Video

Making Suggestions

Video Analysis

1. How many suggestions did they get from the box?
2. What was mentioned in the first suggestion?
3. Why was the second suggestion more interesting?



Role-Play

Scenario: A new Memo from HR suggests that more alternative forms of work modes will be introduced in the office. HR is seeking employees' suggestions and recommendations. Study the conversation between two employees.

Thuy: How are things in your department Brian? ***Have you thought about*** the recent memo from HR?

Brian: Hmm, I guess, this news has been the talk of the office for some time now. So, have you ***weighed the pros and cons*** of hybrid work?

Thuy: To be honest, I'd suggest that working from home on some days and working on-site is a winning choice for us.

Brian: For me, I'd **consider** either only working from home or just working at the office, never hybrid.

Thuy: Why don't you **recommend** that to your supervisor and email them about what you think?

Brian: That **seems like a good idea**, and sure I will **propose** that!

Thuy: I'll **finalize my thoughts** after this week.

Brian: Let's **reach an agreement** after this week!

Role-play Analysis

Answer the following questions:

1. What change is the HR department suggesting for its employees?
2. What is Hybrid work mode?
3. Do you like working from home? What are its advantages?
4. How do Thuy and Brian plan to propose their suggestions?
5. Why is the HR department seeking suggestions from the employees?

Discussion

What are some benefits of Working Hybrid in modern offices?



Stressed Syllables

Practice pronouncing these words with the correct stress:

1. prop**o**sal /prə'pouzəl/
2. recom**m**end /ɹɛkə'mɛnd/
3. f**i**nalize /'faɪ.nə.laɪz/
4. im**pl**ement /'ɪmplɪmənt/
5. a**gr**ee**me**nt /ə'gri:mənt/



Vocabulary

Making Suggestions and Recommendations

Suggestions	Recommendations / Expressing doubt
• What/How about (+ V_ing)? • Why don't we (+ V)? • Maybe we should (+ V) • Perhaps we could (+ V) • Couldn't we (+ V)? • Have you thought about (+ V_ing)? • We could always (+ V)	• I think we should consider (+ noun / + V_ing) • We might be better off (+ V_ing) • It's probably worth (+ V_ing) • I'd recommend (+ that / + -ing) • It would be better to (+ verb) • It might prove (+ adjective) • I have a few reservations about (+ noun / + V_ing) • I'd rather not (+ verb)

Responding

Accepting	Politely declining
• I really like it. • It's/That's a good idea. • Great. • Exactly. • Sounds good to me. • I'm on board with that. • Let's go with it.	• Sorry, but I don't think that would work. • I'm not sure. • I'm not sure that would work because... • That could be challenging due to... • Maybe we could think of an alternative.



Practice

Solving a Workplace Problem

Workplace Problems (choose one):

1. Several employees are always late for meetings.
2. Two departments are not communicating well.
3. The office is too noisy for focused work.
4. Many staff are stressed because of too much overtime.
5. Employees are using phones too much during working hours.

Instructions:

- Choose one problem together.
- Student A: Make one suggestion to solve it.
- Student B: Respond, add another suggestion.
- Discuss and agree on one final solution.
- (Optional) Share your decision with the class.



Production

PLANNING A COMPANY EVENT

Requirements:

- You and your partner are planning a company event (for example: a team-building day, an anniversary party, a training workshop).
- Make suggestions about the event and decide together on the best plan.

You must decide together:

- What kind of event will it be?
- Where will it take place?
- What activities will you include?
- What rules or guidelines will you set?

Instructions:

1. Student A suggests the type of event and the place.
2. Student B responds: agree or suggest something different.
3. Together, make at least three decisions about the event.
4. Prepare to share your final plan with the class.

CRITERIA FOR MARKING

Criterion	Score	Remarks
1. Clarity of ideas	1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10	
2. Use of Vocabs	1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10	
3. Quality of Reasoning	1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10	

Discussion:

1. What are some polite ways to suggest a new idea during a meeting?
2. How can a team reach a decision when members have different opinions?
3. What is an appropriate way to respond if you disagree with a colleague's decision?

Lesson 14

Making Decisions in Teams



Warm-Up

Motivation Questions:

1. *When your team needs to make an important decision, what steps do you usually take before deciding?*
2. *How do you think involving all team members in decision-making affects the outcome?*



Role-Play

Team Decisions at BrightWave Design

BrightWave Design is a mid-sized creative agency well known for its collaborative way of working. The company believes that the best results come when all team members actively contribute to important decisions. In each project, the **decision-making process** starts with an open team **discussion**, where different perspectives are encouraged. This allows designers, project managers, and marketing staff to share their views before a decision is made.

Sometimes, reaching **consensus** can take time. However, the process is seen as an opportunity to explore ideas rather than as a personal challenge. When the team cannot find immediate agreement, they may organise a short **brainstorming session** to generate as many ideas as possible, and then **evaluate** each option carefully. BrightWave's managers aim to avoid a **top-down system**, because they believe it limits creativity and ownership.

A key feature of the company's culture is that every member has an **equal vote** in major project decisions. The final choice is made when there is clear agreement across the group, ensuring that everyone feels committed to the plan. This inclusive style can sometimes take longer, but it helps build trust and ensures the whole team moves forward together.

Match the words in bold to the definitions 1–7

1. Talking together to exchange and compare ideas _____
2. A structured way of reaching a choice in which more than one person is involved _____
3. People have the same power in deciding on something _____
4. The first stage of working on ideas, often quick and creative _____
5. A management style where instructions and decisions come mainly from senior staff _____
6. Looking at something carefully before making a decision _____
7. A situation when everyone agrees _____



Theory

Styles in Decision-Making

Top-Down

- Leader decides and informs the team.
- Common in hierarchical cultures.

Consensus

- Group discusses and agrees before action.
- Common in collectivist cultures.



Majority Vote

- Decision based on majority opinion.
- Used when opinions differ in democratic settings



Pronunciation

Word stress

Rule 1: Two-syllable nouns and adjectives

Stress usually falls on the **first** syllable.

Examples: *PROject, MARket, LEAders*

Rule 2: Two-syllable verbs

Stress usually falls on the **second** syllable.

Examples: *prePARE, rePORT, disCUSS*

Rule 3: Words ending in -ic, -sion, -tion

Stress on the **second-to-last** syllable.

Examples: *strategic, decision, preSENTation*

Rule 5: Words ending in -ity, -graphy, -ial

Stress on the **third-to-last** syllable.

Examples: *proDUctivity, phoTOgraphy, comMERcial*

Rule 6: Compound nouns

Stress on the **first part** of the compound.

Examples: *BUSiness plan, MARket share, PROject manager*



Practice

Decision-Making Styles Discussion

Group A: Make a list of the advantages of team decision-making where every member has an equal vote, and the disadvantages of a top-down decision-making style.

Group B: Make a list of the disadvantages of team decision-making where everyone has an equal vote, and the advantages of a top-down decision-making style.

Then each group presents its lists of advantages and disadvantages, and the whole class can discuss the different views. Try to reach a consensus about the best approach to decision-making.



Production

DISCUSSION: DECISION-MAKING AS A GROUP

Work in pairs or groups, discuss the following questions:

1. How can teams make sure all members contribute ideas?
2. Which decision-making style do you think works best for IT projects?
3. Which style do you think works best for urgent decisions?
4. What steps should a team follow to make a good decision?
5. How important is it to evaluate all possible options before deciding?
6. How can teams avoid arguments becoming personal conflicts?
7. How can leaders encourage agreement without forcing it?
8. How can teams make decisions faster without losing quality?
9. When is it better to delegate a decision to one person?
10. How does company culture influence decision-making styles?

While discussing, take note of your partner's pronunciation in terms of word stress.

Lesson 15

Review - Lessons 11 - 14



Review Questions

DISCUSSION

- How do you **update your manager** on task progress clearly and briefly?
- What information should you include when **delegating a task**?
- What's the difference between **asking someone to do something** and **delegating responsibility**?
- How do you check understanding after delegating a task?
- What are the two main factors in a **decision matrix**?
- What kinds of tasks can be **delegated**?
- Which tasks should be **postponed or dropped**?
- How can a decision matrix help teams work more efficiently?
- How do you make a **soft suggestion**?
- How do you make a **strong recommendation**?
- How do you respond if you **don't agree** with a suggestion?
- How do you ask for other people's opinions?
- What language helps keep decisions polite and professional?
- What phrases help move a discussion towards a decision?
- How do you summarise options before deciding?
- How do you handle disagreement in a team discussion?
- How do you confirm a final decision clearly?
- What language shows collaboration, not authority?



Practice 1

LISTENING

Listen to the conversation and choose the correct answers for the following questions.

1. What task has already been completed?

- a) Documentation
- b) Testing phase
- c) Release notes
- d) User guide

2. Which task is the top priority?

- a) Release notes
- b) Testing phase
- c) User guide
- d) Documentation

3. How long will Alex need for the release notes?

- a) One day
- b) Two days
- c) Three days
- d) Four days

4. In the conversation, the manager says “We should finalize the user guide before the release.” What does “finalize” mean in this context?

- a) To start writing the user guide
- b) To make the user guide complete and ready for use
- c) To cancel the user guide
- d) To delay the user guide until later



Practice 2

MAKING SUGGESTIONS, DECISIONS, AND DELEGATING TASKS IN TEAM

Scenario:

Your team received negative feedback from clients about poor English communication in meetings and emails. Management has asked you to create an action plan to improve English communication quickly and effectively.

What you need to do:

1. Work in pairs or small teams (3–4 people).
2. Discuss and **make suggestions** about what actions your team should take.
3. **Prioritize tasks** using the Decision Matrix (Urgent vs Important). Decide which tasks are most urgent and important.
4. Choose the **top 3 priority tasks** for your action plan.
5. **Delegate** tasks to team members using polite phrases:
 - *“Could you handle...?”*
 - *“Would you mind taking care of...?”*
 - *“I’ll take responsibility for...”*
6. Agree on the **final plan** using phrases like:
 - *“Shall we agree on this plan?”*
 - *“Let’s go with these priorities.”*
7. Prepare to **present** your plan to the class:
 - Your suggestions and reasoning
 - Your prioritized tasks
 - Your delegation plan

Listening Transcript

Manager: Hi, Alex. How's the progress on the software update?

Alex: We've completed the testing phase, but the documentation still needs work.

Manager: Okay. I think we should finalize the user guide before the release. Can you handle that?

Alex: Sure, I'll take care of the user guide.

Manager: Great. We also need someone to prepare the release notes. Would you mind doing that too?

Alex: I can do that, but I'll need two days.

Manager: That's fine. Let's prioritize the user guide first, then the release notes. Shall we agree on this plan?

Alex: Yes, that works for me.

Lesson 16

Making Requests and Offering Help

 Warm-Up

1. Can you describe a time when you had to make a request at work?
2. How did you approach the situation?
3. What was the outcome?





Role-Play

Scenario: David is working on a project with Pia, and he needs some assistance. Pia is busy with her own tasks.

David: Hi, Pia. How's your schedule today?

Pia: Well, I am reviewing my report before submitting it. Why do you ask?

David: I'm working on the project report and I'm having some trouble with data analysis. *Would you mind* helping me out?

Pia: *Let me know how I can help*. What specifically do you need assistance with?

David: I'm having trouble understanding the trends in data. *I'd really appreciate it if* you could take a look and share some insights.

Pia: Okay, I can take a look. *If it's not too much trouble*, can you help me with my task, too? I need someone to review my report before I submit it.

David: Absolutely, I'd be happy to help. Let's trade favors – you help me with my data analysis, and I'll review your report.

Role-Play Analysis

1. How did David approach Pia for his request? What was his request?
2. What polite expression did David use for his request?
3. Does Pia sound like she really wanted to do the request of David? Why or why not?
4. Did Pia also make requests for David? What was her request?
5. Were the requests for each other clear? Why or why not?



Making Requests & Offering Help: Phrases

Making Requests

Making request	Accepting	Rejecting
• Could you please + Base Verb • Could I ask you to...? • Would you mind + V_ing? * • Do you think you could...? • I'd really appreciate it if...	• Yes, sure. • Yes, of course. • Certainly. • Go ahead. • No, not at all. * • No problem.	• I'm afraid not. • I'm sorry, but... • I'm afraid that's not possible

* "No, not at all." is the positive response for the questions with "mind".

Offering Help

Let me know if you need any help. – used to offer assistance or support.

Example: *Let me know if you need any help with this project.*

Let me know how I can help. – used to help, support, and willingness to help.

Example: *Let me know how I can help you with this project.*



Vocabulary: Direct vs. Indirect Requests

1. **Softening Language** – used to reduce directness of a message, making it less confrontational or aggressive.

Examples:

- **Direct Request** – I need the report by Friday.
- **Indirect / Softened** – *I was wondering if* it would be possible to get the report by Friday?
- **Direct Request** – You need to provide feedback on this report.
- **Indirect / Softened** – *I'd appreciate it if* you could provide feedback on this report.

2. **Formal Phrasing** – the use of polite, professional, and objective language in written or spoken communication, particularly in formal or business settings.

Examples:

- **Direct Request** – Can you help me?
- **Indirect / Formal** – *I would appreciate it if* you could assist me with this matter.
- **Direct Request** – Can you submit the latest sales figures?
- **Indirect / Formal** – *Could you please* provide me with the latest sales figures?



Practice

With a partner, take turns to make and respond to the following requests.

1. Send me the minutes of the last meeting.
2. Book a flight for the business trip.
3. Finish the project by the end of the month.
4. Cover my shift on Saturday.

5. Change the company's social media policy.
6. Finish this report by Friday.
7. Book a meeting room for the conference.
8. Send me the sales data by the end of the day.
9. Cover the customer service phone line.
10. Change the project deadline.



Production

ROLE-PLAY: MAKING REQUEST AND OFFERING HELP

- Work in pairs.
- Each pair will be provided with one of the role-play scenarios below.
- One member will take on the role of the person making a request, while the other will be the person offering help.
- Act out the role-play using polite phrases from the vocabulary.
- If time permits, switch roles and practice with another scenario.

SCENARIO

Scenario 1: The Report Deadline

- **Requester:** You need to finish a project report by the end of the day but are struggling with some sections.
- **Helper:** You have already completed your own report and can offer help with proofreading and giving feedback.

Scenario 2: Moving Day

- **Requester:** You are moving to a new apartment this weekend and need help with lifting heavy boxes.
- **Helper:** You're willing to help with heavy lifting, but you also have some errands to run that day. Offer to help if you can work out a time.

Scenario 3: Preparing for a Presentation

- **Requester:** You're preparing for a big presentation and need assistance with practicing your delivery.
- **Helper:** You have experience with presentations and can offer to listen and provide constructive feedback, but you need to finish a project first.

Scenario 4: Running Errands

- **Requester:** You need to pick up medication from the pharmacy and also need to go grocery shopping but are short on time.
- **Helper:** You can offer to pick up the medication for Jamie while you're out, but ask if Jamie can handle the grocery shopping.

Scenario 5: Team Project

- **Requester:** You are struggling with certain aspects of a team project and need help from a teammate.
- **Helper:** You're available to help and suggest meeting after class to discuss the project in detail.

Discussion:

1. How did you feel when making requests? Was it easy or challenging for you?
2. What strategies did you use to ensure your requests were polite and effective?
3. Did you find it easier to make requests or to offer help? Why?
4. What phrases or expressions did you find particularly useful during the role-play?
5. How did your partner respond to your requests? Did they seem willing to help?

Reflection

1. What's the difference between being direct and being indirect in making requests? Give an example.
2. How do you handle requests that are unclear or ambiguous? Can you walk me through your process?
3. How do you handle requests that are outside of your job description or expertise? Can you walk me through your process?

4. How can you handle situations where someone is not responding to your polite requests?
5. What can you do if a polite request is misinterpreted in a different culture?

Lesson 17

Giving Constructive Feedback



Warm-Up

1. How do you feel when someone criticizes your work?
2. What makes criticism helpful or harmful?
3. Share an example of feedback you received that motivated you.



Feedback Examples

Scenario: A manager giving feedback to a team member about a report.

Feedback 1:

"Your report was very detailed and well-structured. One thing that could make it even stronger is adding more data to support your conclusions. Overall, great effort. I can see the hard work you put in."

Analysis Questions:

1. What positive points did the manager highlight?
2. How did the manager introduce the suggestion for improvement?
3. What tone does the feedback convey?

Feedback 2:

"This report is full of problems. You didn't include enough data, and it's not good enough. You need to fix this immediately."

Analysis Questions:

1. How would this feedback make the recipient feel?
2. What is missing compared to the first feedback?
3. Why might this approach harm team morale?

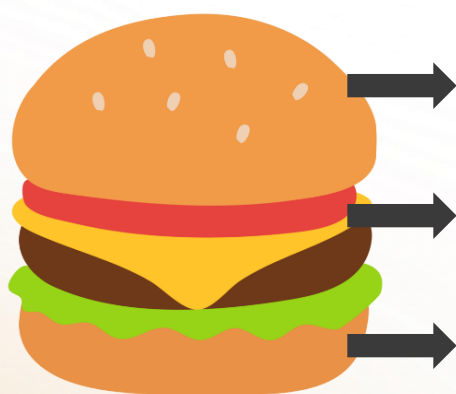


Rules and Technique

THREE RULES FOR NEGATIVE FEEDBACK

Rule	Bad Example	Good Example
1. Focus on actions, not character	"You're careless."	"The client's name was wrong in yesterday's report. Let's make sure we check names before we send things out."
2. Be specific and use evidence	"Your graphs are confusing."	"In your Q3 report, the sales forecast graph on page 7 had no labels on its axes. This made the data hard to understand."
3. Offer helpful ideas or directions	"Scrap it and do it again."	"In your Q3 report, the sales graph on page 7 didn't have labels. This made it hard to understand what the data meant. <i>If you add clear labels to both sides of the graph, everyone will understand the information much faster.</i> "

HAMBURGER TECHNIQUE



Praise

Start with a positive observation

Specific Improvement

Deliver constructive, actionable feedback

Encouragement

End with a supportive statement



Vocabulary: Language for Negative feedback

1. Modal verbs - could, might, would

- You **could** add more visuals to make the presentation clearer.
- It **might** be helpful to include a summary at the end of your report.
- I think it **would** improve the flow if you reorganized the sections.

2. Formal Phrasing

Positive start:

- “I really **appreciate** the effort you put into...”
- “You did a great job with...”

Constructive feedback (all verbs are in positive):

- “It’s **near perfect** and it would be perfect if...”
- “It might be clearer if you...”
- “I like your idea, but it could be better if...”

Helpful suggestions:

- “Perhaps we could try...”
- “It could be useful to...”
- “Maybe **consider** + **V_ing**...”



Practice

BETTER FEEDBACK

Work in pairs. One reads the “bad” feedback sentence, the other rewrites it into constructive feedback following the 3 rules.

1. “Your report is messy.”
2. “You are careless with details.”
3. “Your presentation was boring.”
4. “You didn’t do your job properly.”
5. “You are always late to meetings.”

6. “Your email doesn’t make any sense.”
7. “The design looks bad.”
8. “You didn’t work hard enough on this project.”
9. “Your customer service is terrible.”
10. “You don’t know what you’re doing.”



Production

GIVING CONSTRUCTIVE FEEDBACK

- Work in pairs or groups of three
- Each chooses a scenario from the list
- Take turns to practice giving constructive criticism for the scenarios

Scenario

1. Your colleague submitted a report two days late, and some data is missing.
2. The sales presentation had good visuals but no clear explanation of the pricing details.
3. A customer email your colleague wrote had spelling mistakes and was unclear in answering the client's question.
4. A team member spoke for too long in a meeting, preventing others from contributing.
5. A marketing flyer looks attractive but uses outdated company branding.
6. The financial report contains all the facts but is not logically organised.
7. Your colleague forgot to follow up with a potential client, and the client chose a competitor.
8. A team member completed their task well but didn’t communicate progress, causing delays.
9. A training session was engaging but did not cover all required topics.
10. The demo was visually impressive but lacked a live Q&A, leaving customer concerns unanswered.

Discussion:

1. What challenges do you face when giving criticism?
2. How did you feel when receiving it?
3. Which part of the Hamburger Model was easiest for you? Which was hardest?
4. How do cultural differences affect feedback styles?
5. Why is tone important in professional feedback?

Lesson 18

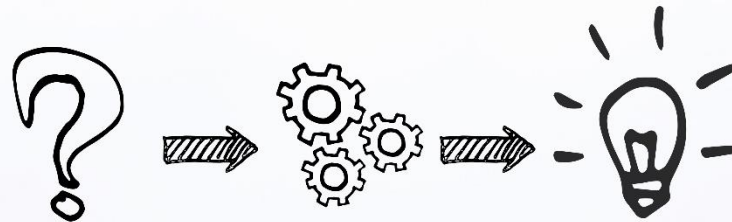
Problems and Solutions



Warm-Up

Motivation Questions:

1. What small problems do you see often in your workplace/team?
2. Think of the last problem your team had. How did you solve it?
3. Have you ever found the cause of a problem that others didn't notice? What was it?
4. Do you prefer solving problems alone or with a team? Why?





Role-Play

Scenario: A manager and an employee discussing a problem with a project deadline.

Manager: We've encountered a delay in the project. What do you think caused this issue?

Employee: I believe the delay is **due to** unforeseen technical difficulties. The software we were using crashed unexpectedly, and it took us a while to get it back up and running.

Manager: I see. Were there any other factors that **contributed to** the delay?

Employee: Yes, there were also some issues with the supplier. They delivered the materials late, which set us back a few days.

Manager: That's concerning. Have we **addressed these issues** with the supplier?

Employee: We have. I've already contacted them, and they've assured us that future deliveries will be on time.

Manager: Good to hear. What steps have we taken to **mitigate** the technical difficulties?

Employee: We've updated the software and implemented a backup system to prevent future crashes. Additionally, we've scheduled regular maintenance checks.

Manager: Excellent. Let's ensure we keep a close eye on these areas moving forward. Is there anything else we need to consider?

Employee: We might need to allocate more resources to the project to make up for lost time. Perhaps we can bring in additional team members.

Manager: That's a good idea. I'll look into reallocating some resources. Let's also set up a meeting with the team to discuss these changes and ensure everyone is on the same page.

Employee: Agreed. I'll prepare a report on the current status and the steps we've taken so far.

Manager: Thank you. Let's aim to get back on track as soon as possible. Keep me updated on any further developments.

Role-play Analysis

1. What are the two main issues causing the project delay?
2. What steps does the employee take to prevent future technical difficulties?
3. What solution does the employee suggest to make up for lost time?
4. How does the employee plan to keep the manager informed about the project's progress?
5. How effective do you think the communication between the manager and the employee is in this dialogue?



Grammar

Modals verbs

1. **Should** - Strong advice or recommendation

Example: *You should review the report before the meeting.*

2. **Could** - Suggesting possible options

Example: *We could try a different approach.*

3. **Might** - Suggesting a less certain option

Example: *You might want to check the backup files.*

4. **Need to** - Expressing necessity

Example: *We need to finish this task today.*

5. **Have to** - Indicating obligation

Example: *You have to submit the update by 5 PM.*

6. **Must** - Strong obligation or requirement

Example: *All changes must be approved by the manager.*



Problem Solving Strategy

How to Identify Problems and Propose Solutions

1. **Define the situation** - State facts clearly and objectively.
2. **Identify the core problem** - Separate real causes from symptoms.
3. **Analyze causes** - Ask open-ended questions and consider different perspectives.
4. **Brainstorm solutions** - Include both short-term and long-term ideas.
5. **Evaluate options** - Check feasibility, respect, and cultural appropriateness.
6. **Select & implement** - Assign roles and set clear deadlines.
7. **Monitor & follow up** - Review, adjust.

Asking Check Questions

Check Questions for Details	Check Questions for Solution Evaluation
What exactly isn't working?	Could we implement this in the time we have?
Which step caused the delay?	Do we have enough resources/budget?
Have you tried_____?	Might this cause other problems?
Did you_____?	Could this affect other projects/clients?
Could it be related to _____?	Which option works best long term?
Am I right that _____ is the cause?	Would all stakeholders accept this plan?
Do we have any evidence for that?	Shall we go ahead with this solution?



Practice

Workplace Problem-Solving Workshop

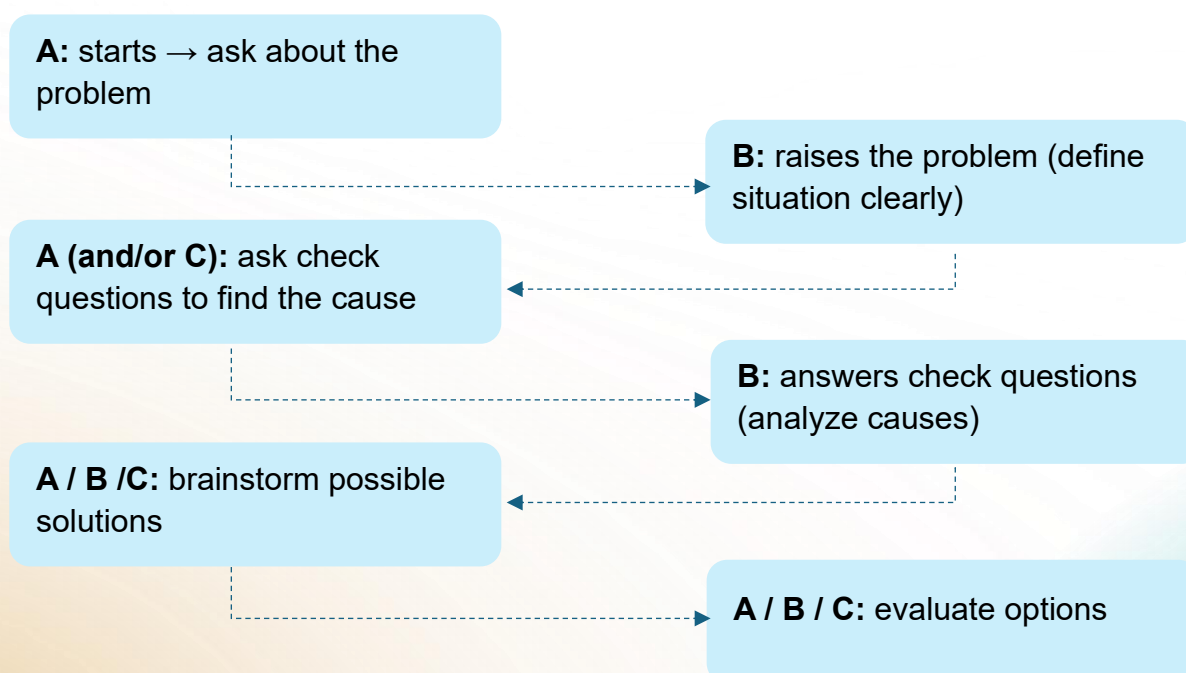
1. Work in pairs.
2. Brainstorm common issues in your workplace or projects (e.g., communication gaps, missed deadlines, unclear roles).
3. Each member chooses one problem and makes one suggestion for solution using modal verbs.



Production

Problem-Solving Practice

1. Work in pairs or small groups.
2. Each pair/group chooses or teacher assigns one issue from the list in the **Practice activity**.
3. Brainstorm solutions for the issue applying the 7 steps.
4. **Output:** Each pair prepares a 2-minute summary of their problem and proposed solution.



Discussion

1. What do you find the most difficult in solving problems at work?
2. What should you do to make sure problems are addressed in your workplace?
3. Can you describe one real problem at work you solved or could solve using today's strategies and phrases?



Key Vocabulary

Target Phrases	Use	Example
The main challenge is...	Stating the main issue	<i>The main challenge is meeting the project deadline with our current resources.</i>
The root cause seems to be...	To tell what the main cause of the problem is	<i>The root cause seems to be a lack of communication between the teams.</i>
A possible solution could be...	A valid suggestion to a problem	<i>A possible solution could be to implement regular check-in meetings to improve communication.</i>
Due to	Explaining the cause of a problem	<i>The delay was due to a software crash last week.</i>
Contribute to	Showing something that adds or leads to a problem or solution	<i>Poor planning contributed to the missed deadline.</i>
Address the issue	Showing action taken to deal with a problem	<i>We need to address the issue with the supplier immediately.</i>
Mitigate	Reducing the negative effect of a problem	<i>We updated the backup system to mitigate the risk of data loss.</i>

Lesson 19

Handling Workplace Issues



Warm-Up

1. In your culture, how do people usually interpret deadlines like “by Monday” or “ASAP”?
2. Have you ever misunderstood something a colleague said or wrote? What happened?
3. In your workplace, what do people usually do when instructions are unclear?





Case Study

Read the case study and answer the questions clearly, using details from the text to support your responses.

Ahmed, a marketing specialist in Dubai, works with Keiko, a designer in Tokyo, on an urgent campaign. Ahmed sends Keiko a message asking for the final design “by next Monday.”

In Ahmed’s company, when they say “by Monday,” it means **Monday morning at the latest**.

Keiko understands “by Monday” to mean **any time before midnight on Monday**.

On Monday afternoon, Ahmed sees no design file and assumes Keiko is late. Keiko sends the file at 11:30 p.m. Japan time — perfectly on schedule according to her understanding.

Ahmed complains in a group chat that the delay has affected printing plans, and Keiko feels unfairly blamed. Neither had clarified the exact delivery time when planning.

Case Study Analysis

Answer the following questions:

1. Why do you think this situation happened?
2. What key misunderstandings can you see here?
3. How could Ahmed and Keiko have avoided this problem?
4. If it happened in your workplace, what steps would you take to solve it?
5. What would be a polite way to clarify the expected delivery time in this situation?
6. What clear communication habits can teams use to stop similar issues in the future?



Techniques for Effective Collaboration

A. Paraphrasing

Restate others' points in your own words to ensure mutual understanding.

“So, you’re saying that...”
 “In other words,...”
 “Let me see if I understand: ...”
 “What you mean is...”
 “To put it another way...”
 “If I’m hearing you correctly...”

Example: “To confirm, you would like the report submitted by Friday, correct?”

B. Requesting Clarification / Repetition

Ask for Clarification	Ask for Repetition
“Do/Did you mean...?”	“Sorry, could you say that again?”
“Sorry, did you say...?”	“Would you mind repeating that?”
“Are you saying that...?”	“Could you repeat the last part, please?”
“What do you mean by....?”	“I didn’t catch that — could you say it once more?”
“Can you clarify that point?”	

C. Resolution Linkers

Phrases to guide discussions toward solutions or agreement

“Therefore,”

“As a result,”

“To resolve this,”

“Moving forward”

Examples:

- *Therefore, we can adjust the schedule accordingly.*
- *Moving forward, we will implement this process to avoid delays*



Practice

A - Paraphrasing Drill

Work with a partner. Take turns to read aloud one statement, then paraphrase it.

1. "We're behind schedule because the supplier delivered late."
2. "The meeting was postponed due to a conflict in the manager's calendar."
3. "Several emails were misunderstood, which led to mistakes in the report."
4. "The software crashed and we lost two hours of work."
5. "A team member is absent, so we have to redistribute their tasks."
6. "Client feedback arrived too late to make changes before the deadline."
7. "Noise in the open office makes it hard to concentrate."
8. "Important files were misplaced during the office move."

B - Clarification Challenge

Work with a partner. Use the information to have short conversations. Take turns to ask for clarification, using the prompts in **B** and the expressions learned.

Example:

A: We must send the report on 21st October.

B: Sorry, did you say the 21st or the 31st?

A: I said the 21st.

A	B
Send / report / 21st October	21st? / 31st?
Reduce / energy consumption / next year	The whole company? / Just the factory?
Improve / results / recycling	Recycling? / Paper? / Other materials too?
Need / 15% reduction / heating bills	15? / 50?
Company canteen / not eco-friendly	Not eco-friendly?



Production

A - DEBATE

Topic: *“Is it better to address workplace problems privately or in a team meeting?”*

1. Students go into 2 teams - assign Side A (private) or Side B (in a team meeting).
2. Internal planning (3-4 minutes):
 - Prepare 2-3 main arguments supporting your side.
 - Think of 1-2 clarification questions to challenge the other team's points.
3. Debate Round:
 - Teams take turns presenting **one argument at a time**.
 - After each argument, the opposing team asks one clarification question (e.g., “Could you explain what you mean by...?”).
 - Repeat the process until **each team has presented all arguments**.
4. Each team uses resolution linkers to connect arguments to outcomes.
5. Class votes: which team gave the clearest, most convincing arguments?

Voting Criteria

- A. Content & Relevance** - How clear, relevant, and well-supported the arguments are. **(5)**
- B. Language & Professionalism** - Use of business-appropriate language, correct grammar, paraphrasing, and resolution linkers. **(5)**
- C. Engagement & Interaction** - Active listening, respectful responses, and addressing opposing points effectively. **(5)**
- D. Organization & Clarity** - Logical structure and clear presentation of ideas. **(5)**

B - DISCUSSION

To understand more about handling workplace issues, discuss to answer the following questions:

1. What types of workplace issues are the hardest to solve? Why?
2. How can misunderstanding between colleagues affect teamwork and productivity?
3. What communication habits help prevent workplace issues before they start?
4. How do cultural differences influence how people solve problems at work?
5. When a problem happens, what's better: focus on quick fixes or look for long-term solutions? Why?
6. Think of a time you saw a workplace misunderstanding — how was it resolved (or how could it have been resolved)?

Lesson 20

Final Practice and Revision



Review Questions

Answer each question sensibly. Use the appropriate key words/phrases from previous lessons.

1. What's a polite way to show interest when meeting someone new?
2. How do greetings differ in high-context vs low-context cultures?
3. What topics can be taboo in cross-cultural networking?
4. How would you describe your company's structure using 2–3 key terms?
5. What's the difference between hierarchy and flat organization?
6. What's "scope creep" in project management?
7. How would you clearly explain a process to someone from another department?
8. Name one example of a cultural difference in decision-making.
9. What are the 4 categories in the Eisenhower Matrix?
10. Give two phrases for making business suggestions.
11. How would you politely reject a request for help?
12. What's the "Hamburger model" for feedback?
13. Give one root cause check question and one solution evaluation question.
14. Give one paraphrasing phrase and one clarification phrase.
15. What resolution linker would you use when connecting a problem to its solution?



Pronunciation Review

Say It Right!

Follow the directions below.

- Work with a partner.
- Each student reads one short passage aloud.
- Your partner listens carefully and writes down any pronunciation mistakes they hear.
- After reading, give friendly feedback to each other.

Passage 1: The Attentive Gaze

A young consultant, eager to impress, began his presentation with unwavering eye contact. His seasoned mentor gently reminded him, ***"In some cultures, eye contact is seen as too direct."*** The consultant nodded, realizing, ***"It's important to be mindful of cultural differences."*** During the coffee break, a colleague suggested a different strategy. ***"Let's find a culturally appropriate approach,"*** she offered, demonstrating how to adapt to different cultures to avoid misinterpretation of even simple ***communication styles*** and ***cultural norms*** in ***business etiquette***.

Passage 2: Winning the Team Over

The project lead needed to convince the team to adopt a new software. ***"Let me explain*** why this is beneficial," she started, clearly outlining the advantages. One team member raised a concern. ***"I understand your concerns, but..."*** the lead responded calmly, ready to handle objections with a strong argument. Her goal was to influence a decision and gain buy-in by highlighting benefits and addressing reservations directly.

Pronunciation Pair Assessment Form

Student A Name: _____

Student B Name: _____

Criteria	Yes	Needs Improvement
Clear pronunciation of individual words		
Correct word stress		
Appropriate sentence stress		
Natural intonation (rise and fall)		
Smooth pace and rhythm		

Comments for your partner (1–2 sentences):



Practice

LANGUAGE IN ACTION

- Pair up and receive different role cards: A and B
- Engage in a conversation with your partner based on your task and the scenario's objective.
- Act naturally, use relevant vocabulary and phrases from earlier lessons, and aim for a realistic outcome.

1. Organization Basics: Meeting with a New Team Member

Role Card A:

Role	Line Manager
Company	Innovatech Solutions
Context	Welcoming a new hire to your department.
Your tasks	- Describe your department structure - Confirm understanding using tag questions - Explain who handles specific tasks/projects - Use phrases like: <i>You report to... / This team is responsible for...</i>

Role Card B:

Role	New Hire
Company	Innovatech Solutions
Context	Starting your first week in the company.
Your tasks	- Ask questions about chain of command and project responsibilities - Clarify uncertainty about who gives approvals - Use phrases like: <i>Did you mean... / The main challenge is...</i>

2. Problems & Solutions - Late Client Delivery

Role Card A:

Role	Team Lead
Company	Synergy Software
Context	Project for a major client was delivered three days late.
Your tasks	- State issue clearly - Ask root cause check questions - Suggest short-term fix and long-term prevention - Use phrases like: <i>Could it be related to... / Shall we go ahead with this solution?</i>

Role Card B:

Role	Project Coordinator
Company	Synergy Software
Context	Explaining why delivery was late.
Your tasks	- Clarify events leading to delay - Answer cause-check questions with details - Suggest possible solutions - Use phrases like: <i>The root cause seems to be... / A possible solution could be...</i>